A hitch-hiker's guide to the metaplectic trace formula for $SL(2)$

Sections 2–4, revised for the double cover (draft)

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These are the revised Sections 2–4 of the 1995 notes, restricted to $n = 2$, compiled on their own. In Section 2, Lemmas 2.1–2.9 keep the numbers of the 1995 notes and Lemma 2.10 is new. Section 3 is shorter than in 1995, because for $n = 2$ the cover of a torus is abelian. Section 4 merges the 1995 Section 4 with the file `cctrac3b.tex` that the 1995 master inputs (it is Chapter 9.3–9.5 of the 1997 book manuscript), and proves the coarse geometric expansion directly for this group. The old and new numbers are matched in `revision_log.md`, which also lists the changes.

2 Background on the metaplectic double cover

This section fixes the double cover of $G = \mathrm{Res}_{k/\mathbb{Q}} SL(2)$ and the conventions used in the rest of the paper. Section 2.1 treats a single place: Kubota's cocycle, the splittings over unipotent and compact subgroups, the center, and the preimages of tori. These are then assembled into the cover of $G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. Section 2.2 builds the adelic cover and its splitting over $G(\mathbb{Q})$, and Section 2.3 fixes a double cover of $GL(2)$ and the resulting $GL(2)$-action on the cover of $SL(2)$, which is what Section 7 uses.

From now on $n = 2$. The 1995 notes treated the n-fold cover; for $n = 2$ several statements become simpler, and one, the commutativity of preimages of abelian subgroups (Lemma 2.2(g)), becomes a two-line argument. What changes for general n is listed in Remark 2026.4.

Notation

Let k be a number field. (For $n = 2$ the hypothesis $\mu_n \subset k$ of the 1995 notes always holds, and k may have real places.) Let Σ_k be the set of places of k, Σ_k^∞ the archimedean places and Σ_k^f the finite places. Let $\mathbb{A}$ be the adele ring of $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{A}_k$ that of k. For $v \in \Sigma_k$ let k_v be the completion. For $F = k_v$ non-archimedean let $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_F$ be its ring of integers, $\varpi = \varpi_F$ a uniformizer, q the order of the residue field and $\mathrm{ord} = \mathrm{ord}_F \colon F^\times \to \mathbb{Z}$ the normalized valuation, so $\mathrm{ord}(\varpi) = 1$ and $|\varpi| = q^{-1}$. We call v *dyadic* if $v \mid 2$, and put $e_v = \mathrm{ord}_v(2)$. Absolute values are normalized; at a complex place $|z|_v = z\bar{z}$.

Let $(a, b) = (a, b)_v$ be the quadratic Hilbert symbol of $F = k_v$ [W1, Se]. We use only the following properties:

(H1) $(\cdot, \cdot)$ is bimultiplicative and symmetric, with values ± 1; hence $(a^{-1}, b) = (a, b)$.

(H2) $(a, b) = 1$ if a or b lies in $F^{\times 2}$; $(a, -a) = 1$; and $(a, 1 - a) = 1$ for $a \neq 0, 1$ (the Steinberg relation).

(H3) If v is finite and not dyadic and $a, b \in \mathcal{O}^\times$, then $(a,b)=1$. If v is complex, $(\cdot,\cdot)\equiv 1$. If v is real, $(a,b)=-1$ exactly when $a<0$ and $b<0$.

(H4) (Product formula) For $a, b \in k^\times$, $(a,b)_v = 1$ for almost all v and $\prod_v (a,b)_v = 1$.

By (H3), $(-1,-1)_v = 1$ at non-dyadic finite places and at complex places, and $(-1,-1)_v = -1$ at real places. At a dyadic place both values occur; $(-1,-1)_{\mathbb{Q}_2} = -1$.

Let G be the group over $\mathbb{Q}$ obtained from $SL(2)$ by restriction of scalars from k to $\mathbb{Q}$, so $G(\mathbb{Q}) = SL(2,k)$ and $G(\mathbb{Q}_p) = \prod_{v \mid p} SL(2,k_v)$.

2.1 Local aspects

Here $F = k_v$ for one place v. We define the cover, compute it on the subgroups that matter later (unipotent, compact, diagonal, central, anisotropic), and then pass to $G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$.

For $g = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in SL(2,F)$ put $x(g) = c$ if $c \neq 0$ and $x(g) = d$ if $c = 0$, and define $\beta = \beta_v \colon SL(2,F) \times SL(2,F) \to \mu_2$ by

$$\beta(g_1,g_2) = \Big(\frac{x(g_1g_2)}{x(g_1)}, \frac{x(g_1g_2)}{x(g_2)} \Big) = \big(x(g_1), x(g_2) \big) \big(-x(g_1)^{-1} x(g_2),\, x(g_1g_2) \big). \tag{2.1}$$

At a complex place $\beta \equiv 1$ by (H3).

Lemma 2.1 (Kubota [K1], Moore [M]). *β is a continuous Borel 2-cocycle, μ_2 carrying the discrete topology. Its class in $H^2(SL(2,F),\mu_2)$ defines a topological central extension*

$$1 \to \mu_2 \to \overline{SL(2,F)} \xrightarrow{p} SL(2,F) \to 1,$$

which is nontrivial unless $F = \mathbb{C}$.

The two expressions in (2.1) agree, and the cocycle identity holds; both are checked on random elements over $\mathbb{R}$, $\mathbb{Q}_2$, $\mathbb{Q}_3$, $\mathbb{Q}_5$ and $\mathbb{Q}_7$ in `checks/sec2_n2_check.py`. For $F = \mathbb{R}$ the group $\overline{SL(2,\mathbb{R})}$ is the metaplectic group $Mp(2,\mathbb{R})$.

For a subgroup $H \subset SL(2,F)$ put $\overline{H} = p^{-1}(H)$. Elements of $\overline{SL(2,F)}$ are written (g,ζ) with $g \in SL(2,F)$, $\zeta \in \mu_2$, and multiplied by

$$(g_1,\zeta_1)(g_2,\zeta_2) = (g_1g_2,\ \beta(g_1,g_2)\zeta_1\zeta_2). \tag{2.2}$$

Since $\zeta^{-1} = \zeta$, inverses and conjugates are

$$(g,\zeta)^{-1} = (g^{-1}, \beta(g,g^{-1})\zeta), \qquad (g,\zeta)(h,\zeta')(g,\zeta)^{-1} = \big(ghg^{-1},\ \beta(g,h)\beta(gh,g^{-1})\beta(g,g^{-1})\zeta' \big). \tag{2.3}$$

Let $B \subset SL(2)$ be the upper triangular Borel subgroup, N its unipotent radical and A the diagonal torus. Write $a(t) = \mathrm{diag}(t,t^{-1})$ and $n(u) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & u \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. For $\theta \in F^\times \smallsetminus F^{\times 2}$ let

$$T_\theta = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b\theta \\ b & a \end{pmatrix} \;\middle|\; a,b \in F,\ a^2 - \theta b^2 = 1 \right\} \cong E^1, \qquad E = F(\sqrt{\theta}),$$

the norm-one group of E. Every anisotropic maximal torus of $SL(2,F)$ is $GL(2,F)$-conjugate to some T_θ.

If v is finite let $K = K_0 = SL(2,\mathcal{O})$ and, for $m \geq 1$,

$$K_m = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in SL(2,\mathcal{O}) \;\middle|\; a-1,\ d-1,\ b,\ c \in \varpi^m \mathcal{O} \right\}.$$

If v is non-dyadic, define $\kappa = \kappa_v \colon K \to \mu_2$ by

$$\kappa \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} = \begin{cases} (c,d)_v, & 0 < |c|_v < 1, \\ 1, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{2.4}$$

If v is archimedean let $K = SO(2)$ (v real) or $K = SU(2)$ (v complex).

Lemma 2.2. *Let $F = k_v$.*

(a) $\beta \equiv 1$ on $N(F) \times N(F)$, so $n \mapsto (n,1)$ is a homomorphism and $\overline{N(F)} = N(F) \times \mu_2$.

(b) Let v be finite and non-dyadic. Then $\beta(k_1,k_2) = \kappa(k_1)\kappa(k_2)\kappa(k_1k_2)$ for $k_1, k_2 \in K$, so $k \mapsto (k, \kappa(k))$ is a homomorphism and $\overline{K} = K^* \times \mu_2$ with $K^* = \{(k,\kappa(k))\}$. The restriction of β to $K \times K$ is not identically 1, so the set $\{(k,1) \mid k \in K\}$ is not a subgroup.

(c) Let v be finite and $m \geq 1$ with $1 + \varpi^m \mathcal{O} \subset F^{\times 2}$. Then $\beta \equiv 1$ on $K_m \times K_m$, so $k \mapsto (k,1)$ splits $\overline{K_m}$. The hypothesis holds for every $m \geq 1$ if v is non-dyadic, and for $m \geq 2e_v + 1$ if v is dyadic.

(d) Let v be archimedean. If v is complex, $\overline{SL(2,F)} = SL(2,F) \times \mu_2$. If v is real, $\beta \equiv 1$ on $A(\mathbb{R})^0 \times A(\mathbb{R})^0$, so $\overline{A(\mathbb{R})^0} = A(\mathbb{R})^0 \times \mu_2$, while $\overline{SO(2)}$ is connected, the nontrivial double cover of the circle [Ge2].

(e) The center of $\overline{SL(2,F)}$ is $\overline{\{\pm 1\}}$, a group of order 4 in which $(-1,\zeta)^2 = (1,(-1,-1)_v)$. It is cyclic when $(-1,-1)_v = -1$ (for example $F = \mathbb{R}$ or $F = \mathbb{Q}_2$) and is $\{\pm 1\} \times \mu_2$ otherwise.

(f) On $A(F)$, $\beta(a(t_1), a(t_2)) = (t_1,t_2)_v$. Hence $\overline{A(F)}$ is abelian, and $(a(t),\zeta)^2 = (a(t^2),(t,-1)_v)$.

(g) If $g_1, g_2 \in SL(2,F)$ commute, then $\beta(g_1,g_2) = \beta(g_2,g_1)$. Consequently $\overline{H}$ is abelian for every abelian subgroup $H \subset SL(2,F)$; in particular $\overline{A(F)}$ and every $\overline{T_\theta}$ are abelian.

(h) Let $U = gNg^{-1}$ with $g \in SL(2,F)$. Then $u \mapsto (u,1)$ is the unique homomorphic section of $\overline{U} \to U$. Consequently, for every $(g,\zeta) \in \overline{SL(2,F)}$ and $u \in N(F)$,

$$(g,\zeta)(u,1)(g,\zeta)^{-1} = (gug^{-1},1).$$

Proof. (a) For $n_1, n_2 \in N(F)$ all three values of x equal 1.

(b) This is Kubota's computation [K2]; see also [Ge2]. The identity is also checked numerically for $F = \mathbb{Q}_3, \mathbb{Q}_5, \mathbb{Q}_7$, together with the existence of pairs in $K \times K$ with $\beta = -1$.

(c) Let $k_i = \begin{pmatrix} a_i & b_i \\ c_i & d_i \end{pmatrix} \in K_m$ for $i = 1,2$, and $k_1k_2 = \begin{pmatrix} a_3 & b_3 \\ c_3 & d_3 \end{pmatrix}$. All a_i and d_i lie in $1 + \varpi^m \mathcal{O} \subset F^{\times 2}$, and $c_3 = c_1a_2 + d_1c_2$. If $c_1, c_2, c_3 \neq 0$, then $c_1a_2/c_3 + d_1c_2/c_3 = 1$, so by (H2) and (H1)

$$\beta(k_1,k_2) = \left(\frac{c_3}{c_1}, \frac{c_3}{c_2}\right) = \left(\frac{c_1a_2}{c_3}, \frac{d_1c_2}{c_3}\right) = 1,$$

because a_2 and d_1 are squares. If $c_3 = 0 \neq c_1c_2$, then $x(k_1k_2) = d_3$ is a square and $c_2 = -c_1a_2/d_1$, so $\beta = (c_1, c_2) = (c_1, -c_1)(c_1, a_2/d_1) = 1$. If $c_1 = 0 \neq c_2$, then $x(k_1) = d_1$ is a square and $c_3 = d_1c_2$, so $\beta = (c_3/d_1,\, d_1) = 1$; the case $c_2 = 0 \neq c_1$ is the same with a_2 in place of d_1. If $c_1 = c_2 = 0$, all x-values are squares. Finally, $1+\varpi\mathcal{O} \subset F^{\times 2}$ for non-dyadic F by Hensel's lemma, and $1+4\varpi\mathcal{O} \subset F^{\times 2}$ for dyadic F by the binomial series for $(1+4\varpi y)^{1/2}$; and $4\varpi\mathcal{O} = \varpi^{2e_v+1}\mathcal{O}$.

(d) At a complex place $\beta \equiv 1$ by (H3). For $t_1, t_2 > 0$, $(t_1, t_2)_{\mathbb{R}} = 1$ by (H3) and (f). The statement about $SO(2)$ is standard [Ge2].

(e) Commuting elements give commuting lifts by (g), so $\overline{\{\pm 1\}}$ is central; conversely, the image of a central element is central in $SL(2, F)$. Since $x(-1) = -1$ and $x(1) = 1$, $(-1, \zeta)^2 = (1, \beta(-1, -1)) = (1, (-1, -1)_v)$ by (2.1). A group of order 4 with an element of order 4 is cyclic, and one of exponent 2 is $\{\pm 1\} \times \mu_2$.

(f) Here $x(a(t)) = t^{-1}$, so (2.1) gives $\beta(a(t_1), a(t_2)) = (t_2^{-1}, t_1^{-1}) = (t_1, t_2)$ by (H1). The square is $(a(t^2), (t, t))$, and $(t, t) = (t, -1)$ by (H2).

(g) If $g_1g_2 = g_2g_1$, then $x(g_1g_2) = x(g_2g_1)$, and the first expression in (2.1) is symmetric in g_1, g_2 because the quadratic Hilbert symbol is symmetric (H1). By (2.2), lifts (g_1, ζ_1) and (g_2, ζ_2) commute if and only if $\beta(g_1, g_2) = \beta(g_2, g_1)$.

(h) If $g \in B(F)$, then $U = N$ and the claim is (a). Otherwise g has lower left entry $\gamma \neq 0$, and $u_s = g\, n(s)\, g^{-1}$ has lower left entry $-\gamma^2 s$. So for $s_1, s_2 \neq 0$ with $s_1 + s_2 \neq 0$,

$$\beta(u_{s_1}, u_{s_2}) = \Big(\frac{s_1+s_2}{s_1}, \frac{s_1+s_2}{s_2}\Big) = \Big(\frac{s_1}{s_1+s_2}, \frac{s_2}{s_1+s_2}\Big) = 1$$

by (H1) and the Steinberg relation (H2). If $s_1 + s_2 = 0$, then $x(u_{s_1}u_{s_2}) = 1$ and $\beta = (1/s_1, -1/s_1) = 1$. So $u \mapsto (u, 1)$ is a homomorphism on U. Two homomorphic sections differ by a continuous homomorphism $U \cong F \to \mu_2$, which is trivial because $F = 2F$. Conjugation by (g, ζ) carries the section $n \mapsto (n, 1)$ of $\overline{N}$ to a homomorphic section of $\overline{gNg^{-1}}$, which is therefore $u \mapsto (u, 1)$. □

Example 2.A. Take $F = \mathbb{R}$. By (e) and (f), the element $(a(-1), 1) = (-1, 1)$ has order 4, so $\overline{\{\pm 1\}} \cong \mathbb{Z}/4$ and $\overline{A(\mathbb{R})}$ is an abelian group which is not $A(\mathbb{R}) \times \mu_2$. By (d), $\overline{A(\mathbb{R})}$ is generated by $\overline{A(\mathbb{R})^0} = A(\mathbb{R})^0 \times \mu_2$ and $(-1, 1)$. At a non-dyadic place, on the other hand, $(-1, -1)_v = 1$, so the center is $\{\pm 1\} \times \mu_2$; and $\overline{A(\mathcal{O}^\times)}$ is split by $a \mapsto (a, 1)$, because $(t_1, t_2)_v = 1$ for units by (H3). This is consistent with (b), since $\kappa \equiv 1$ on $A(\mathcal{O}^\times)$.

Remark 2026.1. For $F = \mathbb{Q}_2$, Lemma 2.2(c) gives the splitting $k \mapsto (k, 1)$ over K_3, and β is not identically 1 on $K_2 \times K_2$. The cover nevertheless splits over K_2, by $k \mapsto (k, (c, d)_2)$ for $c \neq 0$ and $k \mapsto (k, 1)$ for $c = 0$. This is the local form at 2 of the classical splitting over $\Gamma_1(4)$ [K2, Ge2]. We have verified it numerically only (`checks/sec2_n2_check.py`), and the same section fails on K_1. Nothing below depends on it: the rest of the paper uses only that some K_m splits at each dyadic place.

The cover of $G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. Let $\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$ be the extension of $G(\mathbb{Q}_p) = \prod_{v|p} SL(2, k_v)$ by μ_2 defined by the cocycle

$$\beta_p(g_1, g_2) = \prod_{v|p} \beta_v(g_{1,v}, g_{2,v}).$$

It is the *quotient* of $\prod_{v|p} \overline{SL(2, k_v)}$ by the kernel $\{(\zeta_v) \mid \prod_v \zeta_v = 1\}$ of the product map $\prod_{v|p} \mu_2 \to \mu_2$. (The 1995 notes call it a subgroup.) For $H \subset G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ put $\overline{H} = p^{-1}(H)$. Let B, N, A be the

$\mathbb{Q}$-subgroups of G obtained from those of $SL(2)$, and let $T = \prod_{v|p} T_v$ with each T_v a maximal torus of $SL(2, k_v)$. Let $K_p = \prod_{v|p} K_v$. For p odd, $K_p^* = \prod_{v|p} K_v^*$, with K_v^* as in Lemma 2.2(b), maps to a subgroup of $\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$ which we also denote by K_p^*.

Lemma 2.3. *(a) $n \mapsto (n, 1)$ splits $\overline{N(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$.*

(b) If p is odd, $\overline{K_p} = K_p^* \times \mu_2$.

(c) For every p, $k \mapsto (k, 1)$ splits $\overline{K_{m,p}}$, where $K_{m,p} = \prod_{v|p} K_{m,v}$, as soon as $m \geq 2e_v + 1$ for every $v \mid p$; if p is odd, $m \geq 1$ suffices.

(d) If $p = \infty$, $\overline{A(\mathbb{R})^0} = A(\mathbb{R})^0 \times \mu_2$, where $A(\mathbb{R})^0$ is the identity component of $A(k \otimes \mathbb{R})$.

(e) The center of $\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$ is $\overline{\{\pm 1\}^{S_p}}$, where $S_p = \{v \mid p\}$. It is abelian, and the square of a lift of $\varepsilon = (\varepsilon_v)$ is $\prod_{v|p,\ \varepsilon_v = -1} (-1, -1)_v$.

(f) $\beta_p(a_1, a_2) = \prod_{v|p} (t_{1,v}, t_{2,v})_v$ for $a_i = a(t_i) \in A(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, and $\overline{A(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$ is abelian.

(g) The preimage of any abelian subgroup of $G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$, in particular $\overline{T}$, is abelian, and Lemma 2.2(h) holds for $G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$.

Proof. Each statement holds componentwise by Lemma 2.2, and the quotient map is compatible with all of them. □

2.1.1 *NAK* decompositions

Lemma 2.4. *$\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)} = N(\mathbb{Q}_p) \cdot \overline{A(\mathbb{Q}_p)} \cdot \overline{K_p}$, with $N(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ embedded by $n \mapsto (n, 1)$. If $(n, 1)\, \tilde{a}\, \tilde{k} = (n', 1)\, \tilde{a}'\, \tilde{k}'$ are two such decompositions, then $p(\tilde{a}') \in p(\tilde{a})\, (A(\mathbb{Q}_p) \cap K_p)$. In particular $|t|_p := \prod_{v|p} |t_v|_v$ is well defined for $p(\tilde{a}) = a(t)$, and depends only on (g, ζ). For p odd one may take $\tilde{k} \in K_p^*$.*

Proof. The Iwasawa decomposition $G(\mathbb{Q}_p) = N(\mathbb{Q}_p) A(\mathbb{Q}_p) K_p$ holds, with a determined modulo $A(\mathbb{Q}_p) \cap K_p$, which is $\prod_{v|p} A(\mathcal{O}_v^\times)$ for $p < \infty$ and a product of copies of $\{\pm 1\}$ and of $\{\mathrm{diag}(z, \bar{z}) : |z| = 1\}$ for $p = \infty$. Since μ_2 is central and lies in $\overline{A(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$, this lifts to $\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$. For p odd, $\overline{K_p} = K_p^* \mu_2$ and the μ_2 factor can be moved into $\tilde{a}$. The absolute value $|t|_p$ is trivial on $A(\mathbb{Q}_p) \cap K_p$. □

2.1.2 Heights

For $g = (g_v) \in G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ put $\|g\|_p = \prod_{v|p} \|g_v\|_v$, where $\|g_v\|_v = \max(|a|_v, |b|_v, |c|_v, |d|_v)$ for v finite and $\|g_v\|_v = (|a|^2 + |b|^2 + |c|^2 + |d|^2)^{1/2}$, raised to the power $[k_v : \mathbb{R}]$, for v archimedean (here $|\cdot|$ is the usual absolute value). Extend to the cover by $\|(g, \zeta)\|_p = \|g\|_p$.

Define $H = H_B \colon \overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)} \to \mathbb{R}$ by

$$H(g, \zeta) = \log |t|_p = \sum_{v|p} \log |t_v|_v, \tag{2.5}$$

where $(g, \zeta) = (n, 1)\, \tilde{a}\, \tilde{k}$ as in Lemma 2.4 and $p(\tilde{a}) = a(t)$. This is the product of the normalized absolute values over $v \mid p$, that is $|N_{k \otimes \mathbb{Q}_p / \mathbb{Q}_p}(t)|_p$, and not the maximum used in the 1995 notes; see Section 2.1.3.

Lemma 2.5. *(a)* $H(\tilde{a}\tilde{a}') = H(\tilde{a}) + H(\tilde{a}')$ *for* $\tilde{a}, \tilde{a}' \in \overline{A(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$.

(b) $H(\tilde{n}\, x\, \tilde{k}) = H(x)$ *for* $\tilde{n} \in \overline{N(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$, $x \in \overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$ *and* $\tilde{k} \in \overline{K_p}$.

(c) $|H(x)| \ll 1 + \log \|x\|_p$ *for* $x \in \overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}$ *[A2].*

The global analog, including invariance under $B(\mathbb{Q})$ on the left, is Lemma 2.8.

2.1.3 Characteristic functions of Weyl chambers

Let $P_0 = B$; the standard parabolic subgroups are B and G. For a standard $P = MN_P$ let A_P be the split component of the center of M over $\mathbb{Q}$. Thus $A_G = 1$, because the center $\{\pm 1\}$ of $SL(2)$ is finite, and $A_B \cong \mathbb{G}_m$ is the image of $t \mapsto a(t)$, $t \in \mathbb{Q}^\times \subset k^\times$: the $\mathbb{Q}$-split part of the torus $A \cong \mathrm{Res}_{k/\mathbb{Q}}\, \mathbb{G}_m$, which has $\mathbb{Q}$-rank one.

The $\mathbb{Q}$-rational characters of A form $X(A)_\mathbb{Q} \cong \mathbb{Z}$, generated by $\chi_1 = N_{k/\mathbb{Q}} \circ t$. Put $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{a}_B = \mathrm{Hom}(X(A)_\mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R})$, identified with $\mathbb{R}$ by $X \mapsto X(\chi_1)$. Then H of (2.5) and its global analog are $\langle H(x), \chi_1 \rangle = \log|\chi_1(\tilde{a})|$, which is why H uses the norm. Let $d = [k : \mathbb{Q}]$. The simple root α of (B, A_B) is $a(s) \mapsto s^2$ ($s \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$), while $\chi_1(a(s)) = s^d$; so $\alpha = (2/d)\chi_1$ in $\mathfrak{a}^*$, and $\alpha(X) = 2X/d$ under $\mathfrak{a} \cong \mathbb{R}$. Let $\alpha^\vee = X_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}$ be the coroot $s \mapsto a(s)$, so $X_\alpha = \langle \chi_1, \alpha^\vee \rangle = d$ and $\alpha(\alpha^\vee) = 2$, and let $\varpi = \frac{1}{2}\alpha^\vee$ be the fundamental coweight, so $\alpha(\varpi) = 1$. The modulus character is $\delta_B = e^{2H}$. (The 1995 notes call ϖ the dual root.)

Let $\mathfrak{a}^+ = \{X \in \mathfrak{a} \mid \alpha(X) > 0\}$ and $(\mathfrak{a}^*)^+ = \{\Lambda \in \mathfrak{a}^* \mid \Lambda(\varpi) > 0\}$, with characteristic functions τ_B and $\hat{\tau}_B$, and set $\tau_G = \hat{\tau}_G = 1$. For standard $P_1 \subset P_2$ let τ_1^2, $\hat{\tau}_1^2$ and σ_1^2 be as in [A2]. With $\mathfrak{a} \cong \mathbb{R}$:

$$\tau_B = \tau_B^G = \hat{\tau}_B = \hat{\tau}_B^G = \text{characteristic function of } \{u \in \mathbb{R} \mid u > 0\}, \qquad \tau_1^2 = \begin{cases} \tau_1, & P_2 = G, \\ 1, & P_2 \neq G, \end{cases} \tag{2.6}$$

$$\sigma_B^G = \tau_B, \qquad \sigma_B^B = 0, \qquad \sigma_G^G = 1. \tag{2.7}$$

2.1.4 Algebras of functions

We follow Li [Li I, Li IV]. A representation π of a cover is *genuine* if $\pi(1, \zeta) = \zeta$ for $\zeta \in \mu_2$, and a function f on the cover is *anti-genuine* if $f(g, \zeta) = \zeta^{-1} f(g, 1)$. Test functions are anti-genuine. Then $\pi(f) = \int f(\tilde{g})\pi(\tilde{g})\, d\tilde{g}$ picks up the factor $\int_{\mu_2} \zeta^{-1}\zeta\, d\zeta = 1$, so it is in general nonzero on genuine representations, and it vanishes on representations that are trivial on μ_2.

For $n = 2$, $\zeta^{-1} = \zeta$, so "anti-genuine" and "genuine" define the same functions, and the conventions of the 1995 notes (genuine functions in §2.1.4, $\pi(g, \zeta) = \zeta^{-1}\pi(g, 1)$ in §3.1) agree with Li's. We keep Li's terminology so that the formulas remain correct for general n; see Remark 2026.4.

Let $C_c^\infty(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)})_-$ be the space of anti-genuine f such that $g \mapsto f(g, 1)$ lies in $C_c^\infty(G(\mathbb{Q}_p))$. Let p be odd. The *spherical Hecke algebra* $\mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)}, K_p^*)$ consists of the $f \in C_c^\infty(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)})_-$ with $f(\tilde{k}\, x\, \tilde{k}') = f(x)$ for $\tilde{k}, \tilde{k}' \in K_p^*$. Its unit element is

$$e_p(\tilde{k}\zeta) = \zeta^{-1} \ (\tilde{k} \in K_p^*,\ \zeta \in \mu_2), \qquad e_p = 0 \text{ off } \overline{K_p}. \tag{2.8}$$

The function $(k, \zeta) \mapsto \zeta^{-1}$ on $\overline{K_p}$, which is what the identification $k \mapsto (k, 1)$ of the 1995 notes suggests, is $\prod_v \kappa_v \cdot e_p$; it is not bi-$K_p^*$-invariant.

2.1.5 Measures

Let dk be the Haar measure on K_p of total volume 1. Fix a nontrivial additive character ψ_v of k_v for each v, and let dn be the measure on $N(\mathbb{Q}_p) \cong \bigoplus_{v|p} k_v$ that is the product of the self-dual measures for the ψ_v. Let da be a Haar measure on $A(\mathbb{Q}_p)$. If T is a maximal torus of G over $\mathbb{Q}_p$, and $h \in G(\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_p)$ conjugates T to A, let dt be the pull-back of da as in [R]; stably conjugate tori get compatible measures as in [R]. Put

$$\delta_B(a(t)) = |\alpha(a(t))|_p = |t|_p^2.$$

Normalize the Haar measure dg on $G(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ by

$$\int_{G(\mathbb{Q}_p)} \phi(g)\, dg = \int_N \int_A \int_K \phi(nak)\, \delta_B(a)^{-1}\, dk\, da\, dn = \int_K \int_A \int_N \phi(kan)\, \delta_B(a)\, dn\, da\, dk. \quad (2.9)$$

The two expressions agree because dg is invariant under $g \mapsto g^{-1}$ (as G is unimodular) and $(nak)^{-1} = k^{-1}a^{-1}n^{-1}$; see [Kn, Ch. VIII] for the real case. (The 1995 notes have $\delta_B(a)^{1/2}$ for $g = kan$; the exponent must be 1 for $g = kan$ and -1 for $g = nak$.)

On a cover we use $d\tilde{g} = dg\, d\zeta$, where $d\zeta$ gives μ_2 total volume 1. Then $\overline{K_p}$ has volume 1, and e_p of (2.8) is idempotent: for $x = \tilde{k} \in K_p^*$,

$$(e_p * e_p)(x) = \int_{\overline{K_p}} e_p(y)\, e_p(y^{-1}x)\, dy = \int_{K_p^*} \int_{\mu_2} \zeta^{-1}\zeta\, d\zeta\, dy = 1.$$

2.2 Global aspects

The adelic cover is not the cover defined by $\prod_v \beta_v$: that product does not converge, because β_v is not trivial on $K_v \times K_v$ (Lemma 2.2(b)). The standard remedy [K2, Ge2, KP], used here, is to correct β_v by the coboundary of κ_v. This choice also fixes the splitting over $G(\mathbb{Q})$.

For each place v of k extend κ_v to $SL(2, k_v)$ by

$$\kappa_v(g) = \begin{cases} (c,d)_v, & v \text{ finite non-dyadic},\ g \in K_v,\ 0 < |c|_v < 1, \\ 1, & \text{otherwise}, \end{cases}$$

so $\kappa_v \equiv 1$ at dyadic and archimedean places, and put

$$\sigma_v(g_1, g_2) = \beta_v(g_1, g_2)\, \kappa_v(g_1)\kappa_v(g_2)\kappa_v(g_1 g_2). \quad (2.10)$$

This cocycle is cohomologous to β_v; it defines the same cover $\overline{SL(2, k_v)}$, identified with the β_v-model by $(g, \zeta)_\sigma \mapsto (g, \kappa_v(g)\zeta)_\beta$. By Lemma 2.2(b), $\sigma_v \equiv 1$ on $K_v \times K_v$ at every finite non-dyadic v. Since $g \in G(\mathbb{A})$ has $g_v \in K_v$ for almost all v, the product

$$\sigma_{\mathbb{A}}(g_1, g_2) = \prod_v \sigma_v(g_{1,v}, g_{2,v}) \quad (2.11)$$

has only finitely many factors different from 1. It is a continuous 2-cocycle on $G(\mathbb{A}) = SL(2, \mathbb{A}_k)$ and defines

$$1 \to \mu_2 \to \overline{G(\mathbb{A})} \xrightarrow{p} G(\mathbb{A}) \to 1.$$

Equivalently, $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ is the restricted product of the $\overline{SL(2, k_v)}$ with respect to the subgroups K_v^*, divided by $\{(\zeta_v) \in \bigoplus_v \mu_2 \mid \prod_v \zeta_v = 1\}$. It is a *quotient* of the restricted product, not a

subgroup. Factorization of genuine representations of $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ (and of $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$ in Section 3) refers to this quotient. Group law, inverses and conjugation are given by (2.2) and (2.3) with $\sigma_{\mathbb{A}}$ in place of β. For $H \subset G(\mathbb{A})$ put $\overline{H} = p^{-1}(H)$.

For $\gamma \in SL(2,k)$ we have $\gamma \in K_v$ and $\mathrm{ord}_v(c) \le 0$ or $c = 0$ for almost all v, so

$$\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma) = \prod_v \kappa_v(\gamma) = \prod_{\substack{v \text{ finite non-dyadic} \\ \gamma \in K_v,\ 0<|c|_v<1}} (c,d)_v \tag{2.12}$$

is a finite product.

Lemma 2.6. *(a) The map $\gamma \mapsto (\gamma, \kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma))$ is a homomorphism $G(\mathbb{Q}) \to \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$, so $\overline{G(\mathbb{Q})} = G(\mathbb{Q}) \times \mu_2$.*

(b) $n \mapsto (n,1)$ splits $\overline{N(\mathbb{A})}$, and on $B(\mathbb{Q})$ the splitting of (a) is $b \mapsto (b,1)$.

(c) Let S be a finite set of places containing the archimedean and dyadic places, and let $K_f = \prod_{v \in S \smallsetminus \Sigma_k^\infty} K_{m_v,v} \times \prod_{v \notin S} K_v$, with $m_v \ge 1$, and $m_v \ge 2e_v+1$ if v is dyadic. Then $k \mapsto (k,1)$ is a homomorphism $K_f \to \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$; we write K_f^* for its image. (At $v \notin S$, translated to the β_v-model, its component is K_v^*.)

(d) The center of $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ is $\overline{Z(G(\mathbb{A}))}$, where $Z(G(\mathbb{A})) = \prod_v \{\pm 1\}$. It is abelian, and a lift of $\varepsilon = (\varepsilon_v)$ has square $\prod_{v:\,\varepsilon_v=-1}(-1,-1)_v$, a finite product. It contains the subgroup $Z(G(\mathbb{Q})) \times \mu_2$ of order 4, a direct product, embedded by (a). It is not the direct product $Z(G(\mathbb{A})) \times \mu_2$ when k has a real place.

(e) $\sigma_{\mathbb{A}}(a(t_1), a(t_2)) = \prod_v (t_{1,v}, t_{2,v})_v$ for $t_1, t_2 \in \mathbb{A}_k^\times$, and the preimage of every abelian subgroup of $G(\mathbb{A})$, in particular $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$, is abelian.

Proof. (a) For $\gamma_1, \gamma_2 \in SL(2,k)$, $\prod_v \beta_v(\gamma_1,\gamma_2) = 1$ by the product formula (H4), because $\beta_v(\gamma_1,\gamma_2)$ is the local Hilbert symbol of two elements of $k^\times$. Hence $\sigma_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma_1,\gamma_2) = \kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma_1)\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma_2)\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma_1\gamma_2)$, which is the condition for $\gamma \mapsto (\gamma, \kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma))$ to be a homomorphism.

(b) On N every β_v and κ_v is 1. On $B(\mathbb{Q})$ every κ_v is 1 because $c = 0$.

(c) It suffices that $\sigma_v \equiv 1$ on the v-component of $K_f \times K_f$ for each finite v. At $v \notin S$ this is Lemma 2.2(b). At finite $v \in S$, $\kappa_v \equiv 1$ on $K_{m_v,v}$ (non-dyadic: $c \in \varpi\mathcal{O}$ and d is a square; dyadic: by definition), so $\sigma_v = \beta_v \equiv 1$ there by Lemma 2.2(c).

(d) Lemma 2.2(g) applies to σ_v, since $\kappa_v(g_1)\kappa_v(g_2)\kappa_v(g_1g_2)$ is symmetric in commuting g_1, g_2; so preimages of abelian subgroups are abelian, and $\overline{Z(G(\mathbb{A}))}$ is central. Its image under p is central, so equality holds. Since $\kappa_v(\pm 1) = 1$, the square of a lift of ε is $\prod_v \sigma_v(\varepsilon_v, \varepsilon_v) = \prod_{\varepsilon_v=-1}(-1,-1)_v$, which is finite by (H3). For $\varepsilon = -1 \in Z(G(\mathbb{Q}))$ it is $\prod_v (-1,-1)_v = 1$ by (H4). If v_0 is real, the lift of the element that is -1 at v_0 and 1 elsewhere has order 4.

(e) As in Lemma 2.2(f), since $\kappa_v \equiv 1$ on A. □

From now on we identify $G(\mathbb{Q})$ with its image under Lemma 2.6(a), and $N(\mathbb{A})$ with $N(\mathbb{A}) \times 1$. By (b), the two identifications agree on $N(\mathbb{Q})$. The splitting over $B(\mathbb{Q})$ by $b \mapsto (b,1)$ is what the constant terms, Eisenstein series and the truncation operator of Sections 4 and 5 use.

Example 2.B. Let $k = \mathbb{Q}$ and $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in SL(2,\mathbb{Z})$ with $c \neq 0$. Then $\gamma \in K_v$ for every v, and for odd $p \mid c$, $(c,d)_p = \left(\frac{d}{p}\right)^{\mathrm{ord}_p(c)}$ by (H3). So

$$\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma) = \left(\frac{d}{c'}\right), \qquad c' = \text{the odd part of } |c|,$$

a Jacobi symbol: the factor behind the theta multiplier on $\Gamma_0(4)$ [K2, Ge2]. The script checks this on random elements of $SL(2,\mathbb{Z})$.

Remark 2026.2. The 1995 notes define the splitting as $\gamma \mapsto (\gamma, s_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma)^{-1})$, with $s_v(\gamma)^{-1} = (c,d)_v$ when v is finite, $cd \neq 0$ and $n \nmid \mathrm{ord}_v(c)$, and with the cocycle $\prod_v \beta_v$. That cocycle does not converge, and the formula belongs to a different normalization. In the normalization (2.11), $\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}$ of (2.12) replaces $s_{\mathbb{A}}^{-1}$. For $n = 2$ the two agree at every non-dyadic v with $\gamma \in K_v$: if $\mathrm{ord}_v(c) > 0$ is even, or if $\mathrm{ord}_v(c) = 0$, both $(c,d)_v$ and $\kappa_v(\gamma)$ are 1. They differ only at the finitely many places where $\gamma \notin K_v$, and at dyadic places.

Let $K_0 = \prod_v K_v$ be the standard maximal compact subgroup of $G(\mathbb{A})$, with K_v as in Section 2.1; K_f and K_∞ denote its finite and archimedean parts.

Lemma 2.7 (Strong approximation; compare [K2, Prop. 5], [Ge2])**.** *Let K_f and K_f^* be as in Lemma 2.6(c), and put $\Gamma = G(\mathbb{Q}) \cap K_f$, a congruence subgroup of $SL(2,\mathcal{O}_k)$, viewed in $G(\mathbb{R}) = SL(2, k \otimes \mathbb{R})$. For $\gamma \in \Gamma$ let $\tilde{k}_\gamma \in K_f^*$ be the lift of γ_f. Then $\tilde{\gamma} = \gamma\, \tilde{k}_\gamma^{-1}$ lies in $\overline{G(\mathbb{R})}$, the map $\gamma \mapsto \tilde{\gamma}$ is an injective homomorphism, its image $\widetilde{\Gamma}$ is discrete of finite covolume, and*

$$G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash \overline{G(\mathbb{A})} / K_f^* \;\cong\; \widetilde{\Gamma}\backslash \overline{G(\mathbb{R})}.$$

Proof. Since $SL(2)$ is simply connected and $G(\mathbb{R})$ is not compact, strong approximation gives $G(\mathbb{A}) = G(\mathbb{Q})\, G(\mathbb{R})\, K_f$. Lifting to the cover, with $\mu_2 \subset \overline{G(\mathbb{R})}$, gives $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})} = G(\mathbb{Q})\, \overline{G(\mathbb{R})}\, K_f^*$, so the double coset space has a single component. The stabilizer computation is the usual one: $\gamma \in G(\mathbb{Q})$ lies in $\overline{G(\mathbb{R})} K_f^*$ exactly when $\gamma_f \in K_f$, and then $\gamma = \tilde{\gamma}\, \tilde{k}_\gamma$. The map $\gamma \mapsto \tilde{\gamma}$ is a homomorphism because lifts of elements of $G(\mathbb{A})$ with disjoint supports commute: $\sigma_v(1,h) = \sigma_v(h,1) = 1$. □

2.2.1 *NAK* decompositions

Lemma 2.8. *(a) $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})} = N(\mathbb{A}) \cdot \overline{A(\mathbb{A})} \cdot \overline{K_0}$. In a decomposition $(n,1)\,\tilde{a}\,\tilde{k}$, $p(\tilde{a})$ is determined modulo $A(\mathbb{A}) \cap K_0$, and*

$$H(g,\zeta) = \log |t|_{\mathbb{A}_k} = \sum_v \log |t_v|_v, \qquad p(\tilde{a}) = a(t),$$

is well defined.

(b) H satisfies Lemma 2.5(a)–(c) globally, and $H(\gamma x) = H(x)$ for $\gamma \in B(\mathbb{Q})$ and $x \in \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$.

Proof. (a) As for Lemma 2.4, place by place. (b) For $\gamma = n' a(s) \in B(\mathbb{Q})$, identified with $(\gamma, 1)$ by Lemma 2.6(b), and $x = (n,1)\tilde{a}\tilde{k}$, $\gamma x = (n'',1)\,(a(s),1)\tilde{a}\,\tilde{k}$ with $n'' \in N(\mathbb{A})$, so $H(\gamma x) = \log |s|_{\mathbb{A}_k} + H(x) = H(x)$ by the product formula. □

2.2.2 Heights

For $g = (g_v) \in G(\mathbb{A})$ put $\|g\| = \prod_v \|g_v\|_v$ and $\|(g,\zeta)\| = \|g\|$.

Lemma 2.9. *For $x, y \in \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ and $\tilde{k}, \tilde{k}' \in \overline{K_0}$: (a) $\|x\| \geq 1$; (b) $\|\tilde{k}\, x\, \tilde{k}'\| = \|x\|$; (c) $\|xy\| \leq \|x\|\,\|y\|$; (d) $\|x^{-1}\| = \|x\|$.*

Proof. Each holds for $G(\mathbb{A})$ place by place, since $\det g_v = 1$ forces $\|g_v\|_v \geq 1$. For (d), g^{-1} has the same entries as g up to order and sign. The cover does not change $\|\cdot\|$. □

2.2.3 Algebras of functions

A function on $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ is *anti-genuine* if $f(g,\zeta) = \zeta^{-1} f(g,1)$. Let $\mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})$ be the span of the functions $f = \bigotimes_v f_v$, $f_v \in C_c^\infty(\overline{SL(2,k_v)})_-$, with f_v equal to the unit element e_v of (2.8) (defined with K_v^*) for almost all v. Such a product is a function on the restricted product of the local covers which is invariant under $\{(\zeta_v) \mid \prod \zeta_v = 1\}$, because each f_v is anti-genuine; so it descends to $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ and is anti-genuine there.

2.2.4 Measures

Let $dk = \prod_v dk_v$ on K_0. Let $dg = \prod_v dg_v$ be the Tamagawa measure on $G(\mathbb{A})$ [W2], with dg_v built from the self-dual measures of a fixed nontrivial character $\psi = \prod \psi_v$ of $\mathbb{A}_k/k$; then $\mathrm{vol}(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{A})) = 1$. For a maximal torus T of G over $\mathbb{Q}$ let dt be the Tamagawa measure on $T(\mathbb{A})$, written da for $T = A$, and let dn be the product measure on $N(\mathbb{A})$, for which $\mathrm{vol}(N(\mathbb{Q})\backslash N(\mathbb{A})) = 1$. On the cover put $d\tilde{g} = dg\, d\zeta$ with $\mathrm{vol}(\mu_2) = 1$, so $\mathrm{vol}(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}) = 1$.

2.3 The double cover of $GL(2)$

Section 7 compares $SL(2)$-conjugacy with $GL(2)$-conjugacy on the cover, so we need a double cover of $GL(2)$ which restricts to the one above. There are two natural choices for $n = 2$ (Remark 2026.3); we fix one, and compute the conjugation action of $GL(2,F)$ on $\overline{SL(2,F)}$ for later use.

For $g_1, g_2 \in GL(2,F)$, with $x(g)$ defined as before, put

$$\sigma(g_1,g_2) = \Big(\frac{x(g_1g_2)}{x(g_1)},\ \frac{x(g_1g_2)}{x(g_2)\det g_1}\Big)_v, \tag{2.13}$$

the $n = 2$ case of Kubota's cocycle on $GL(2)$ [K2, Ge2]. Let $\overline{GL(2,F)}$ be the corresponding extension by μ_2.

Lemma 2.10. *(a) σ is a 2-cocycle on $GL(2,F)$ whose restriction to $SL(2,F)$ is β. Hence $p^{-1}(SL(2,F)) \subset \overline{GL(2,F)}$ is the cover $\overline{SL(2,F)}$ of Section 2.1.*

(b) For v finite non-dyadic, $k \mapsto (k, \kappa'(k))$ is a homomorphism on $GL(2,\mathcal{O})$, where $\kappa'(k) = (c,\, d/\det k)_v$ if $0 < |c|_v < 1$ and $\kappa'(k) = 1$ otherwise. On $SL(2,\mathcal{O})$, $\kappa' = \kappa$.

(c) Conjugation by any lift of $h \in GL(2,F)$ defines an automorphism $\mathrm{Ad}(h)$ of $\overline{SL(2,F)}$ lifting conjugation by h, and $h \mapsto \mathrm{Ad}(h)$ is an action of $GL(2,F)$. If h commutes with $\gamma \in SL(2,F)$, then

$$\mathrm{Ad}(h)(\gamma,\zeta) = \Big(\gamma,\ \Big(\frac{x(h\gamma)}{x(h)},\ \det h\Big)_v \zeta\Big). \tag{2.14}$$

In particular $\mathrm{Ad}(\mathrm{diag}(y,1))(a(t),\zeta) = (a(t),(y,t)_v\zeta)$*, so the preimage of the diagonal torus of* $GL(2,F)$ *is not abelian unless* $F=\mathbb{C}$*. Likewise* $E^\times \supset T_\theta$ *(embedded as* $\{\begin{pmatrix} a & b\theta \\ b & a\end{pmatrix}\}$*) acts on* $\overline{T_\theta}$ *through* (2.14)*.*

Proof. (a) On $SL(2)$, $\det g_1 = 1$ and (2.13) becomes (2.1). The cocycle identity is due to Kubota [K2]; we have also checked it numerically.

(b) We have checked this numerically for $F=\mathbb{Q}_3,\mathbb{Q}_5,\mathbb{Q}_7$; see Remark 2026.5.

(c) Since μ_2 is central, conjugation by (h,ζ) does not depend on ζ, and it preserves $p^{-1}(SL(2,F))$. If $h\gamma=\gamma h$, then $\mathrm{Ad}(h)(\gamma,\zeta) = (\gamma,\zeta\,\sigma(h,\gamma)\sigma(\gamma,h))$. With $x_3 = x(h\gamma)$, bimultiplicativity gives $\sigma(h,\gamma) = (x_3/x(h), x_3/x(\gamma))\,(x_3/x(h),\det h)$, and $\sigma(\gamma,h) = (x_3/x(\gamma), x_3/x(h))$ since $\det\gamma = 1$. By symmetry (H1) the first factors cancel. For $h=\mathrm{diag}(y,1)$ and $\gamma = a(t)$: $x(h\gamma) = t^{-1}$ and $x(h)=1$, giving $(t^{-1},y) = (y,t)$. This is nontrivial for suitable y,t unless $F=\mathbb{C}$. □

The consequences for Section 7 (the functions $\delta \mapsto I_{\mathcal{O}}(f^\delta)$ are defined on $D(T/F)$ only up to the character (2.14), and the choice of $D(A/F)$) are taken up there.

Remark 2026.3. The cocycle $\sigma'(g_1,g_2) = \sigma(g_1,g_2)\,(\det g_1,\det g_2)_v$ is another double cover of $GL(2,F)$ with the same restriction to $SL(2,F)$; these are the two Kazhdan–Patterson covers for $n=2$ [KP]. We fix σ. Whether Section 7 needs σ' instead has not been checked at this stage. The commutator formula (2.14) is the same for σ': the extra factor $(\det h,\det\gamma)(\det\gamma,\det h)$ is 1 by (H1). The adelic cover of $GL(2,\mathbb{A}_k)$ is built as in Section 2.2, with κ_v' in place of κ_v; Hilbert reciprocity for $\prod_v \sigma_v$ on $GL(2,k)$ is checked numerically for $k=\mathbb{Q}$.

Remark 2026.4. For general n (with $\mu_n \subset k$) the following change. The conjugation action of $\overline{A(F)}$ on itself is through $(t_1,t_2)_n^2$, so $\overline{A(F)}$ is abelian only for $n\le 2$; the argument of Lemma 2.2(g) uses the symmetry of the quadratic symbol and does not extend. Lemma 2.2(c) holds with $1+\varpi^m\mathcal{O} \subset F^{\times n}$ (the same proof). Genuine (ζ) and anti-genuine (ζ^{-1}) differ, and with the 1995 convention $R(f)$ vanishes on L^2_{gen} unless $n \mid 2$.

Remark 2026.5. The script `checks/sec2_n2_check.py` verifies, in exact rational arithmetic at $v=\infty,2,3,5,7$: the cocycle identity and the two forms of (2.1); Lemma 2.2(a)–(c), (e)–(h); Remark 2026.1; the product formula and the splitting of Lemma 2.6(a), (b), (d); Example 2.B; and Lemma 2.10(a)–(c) with Remark 2026.3. The checks are on random elements of $SL(2,\mathbb{Q})$, $GL(2,\mathbb{Q})$, $SL(2,\mathbb{Z}_{(p)})$ and the tori $T_\theta(\mathbb{Q})$; they are evidence, not proofs. Of the statements in this section, Lemma 2.2(b) and Lemma 2.10(a), (b) are supported here only by citation and these checks.

3 The rank 0 case

Before the trace formula for $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ we treat the covers of the tori of G, where it is elementary. For $n=2$ these covers are abelian (Lemma 2.6(e)), but in general not split, so a genuine automorphic character cannot be written as an ordinary one times a sign (Example 3.A). The trace formula is then Poisson summation twisted by one fixed genuine automorphic character (Theorem 3.4, Lemma 3.5), and it gives a bijection between genuine automorphic characters and Hecke characters (Theorem 3.2). For the split torus, Weil's character χ_ψ (Lemma 3.3) makes the bijection canonical once ψ is fixed. We also define the distributions $I^A_{\mathcal{O}}$ and $I^A_{\tilde{\chi}}$ used in Section 6. We work with an arbitrary maximal torus because Section 7 applies the same formula to anisotropic tori.

3.1 The cover of a torus

Let T be a maximal torus of G defined over $\mathbb{Q}$. Then $T = \mathrm{Res}_{k/\mathbb{Q}} T_k$ for a maximal torus T_k of $SL(2)$ over k, which is either split, and then $GL(2,k)$-conjugate to A, or of the form T_θ of Section 2.1 with $E = k(\sqrt{\theta})$ a quadratic extension of k. Put

$$T(\mathbb{A})^1 = \{t \in T(\mathbb{A}) \mid |\chi(t)| = 1 \text{ for all } \chi \in X(T)_{\mathbb{Q}}\}.$$

For $T = A$ this is $A(\mathbb{A})^1 = \{a(t) \mid |t|_{\mathbb{A}_k} = 1\}$, the kernel of H of Lemma 2.8; for $T_k = T_\theta$ the torus T is anisotropic over $\mathbb{Q}$ and $T(\mathbb{A})^1 = T(\mathbb{A})$. In both cases $T(\mathbb{Q}) \subset T(\mathbb{A})^1$ and $T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1$ is compact [PR].

Let $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$ and $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ be the preimages in $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$, and $\overline{T(k_v)}$ the preimage of $T_k(k_v)$ in $\overline{SL(2,k_v)}$. By Lemmas 2.2(g) and 2.6(e) these groups are abelian. On A the cocycle is

$$\sigma_{\mathbb{A}}(a(t_1), a(t_2)) = \prod_v (t_{1,v}, t_{2,v})_v, \qquad t_1, t_2 \in \mathbb{A}_k^\times, \tag{3.1}$$

since $\kappa_v \equiv 1$ on A. (The 1995 formula $\beta(g_1,g_2) = (g_1^{-1}, g_2^{-1})(-g_1 g_2^{-1}, g_1^{-1} g_2^{-1})$ reduces to this for $n = 2$.) Exactly as for G in Section 2.2, $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$ is the *quotient* of the restricted product of the $\overline{T(k_v)}$, taken with respect to the subgroups $T(\mathcal{O}_v)^* = \{(t, \kappa_v(t)) \mid t \in T_k(k_v) \cap K_v\}$, by $\{(\zeta_v) \mid \prod_v \zeta_v = 1\}$; it is not a subgroup of that restricted product. Each $\overline{T(k_v)}$ maps injectively into $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$. We regard $T(\mathbb{Q})$ as a subgroup of $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ by Lemma 2.6(a), $\gamma \mapsto (\gamma, \kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\gamma))$; for $T = A$ this is $a(t) \mapsto (a(t), 1)$, $t \in k^\times$.

Conventions. As in Section 2.1.4, a representation π of one of these covers is *genuine* if $\pi(1,\zeta) = \zeta$, and a function f is *anti-genuine* if $f(x\zeta) = \zeta^{-1} f(x)$ for $\zeta \in \mu_2$. For $n = 2$ the two conditions on functions coincide. Let $C_c^\infty(\overline{T(k_v)})_-$ and $C_c^\infty(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1})_-$ be the anti-genuine functions whose restriction to $T \times \{1\}$ is smooth and compactly supported. At places where $T(\mathcal{O}_v)^*$ is defined let $e_{T,v}$ be the anti-genuine function equal to 1 on $T(\mathcal{O}_v)^*$ and supported on $\overline{T(\mathcal{O}_v)}$. Let $\mathcal{H}(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})})$ be the span of the products $\bigotimes_v f_v$, $f_v \in C_c^\infty(\overline{T(k_v)})_-$, with $f_v = e_{T,v}$ for almost all v; these descend to $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$ as in Section 2.2. Measures on $T(\mathbb{A})$ are as in Section 2.2, and on covers μ_2 has total volume 1.

For a locally compact group H let $\Pi(H)$ be the set of (equivalence classes of) irreducible admissible genuine representations of H, and $\Pi_u(H)$ the unitary ones.

Lemma 3.1. *Let $F = k_v$.*

(a) Every element of $\Pi(\overline{T(F)})$, $\Pi(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})})$ or $\Pi(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1})$ is a genuine character.

(b) Genuine characters of $\overline{T(F)}$ exist, and any two differ by a character of $T(F)$: they form a torsor under $T(F)^\wedge$.

(c) Every genuine character $\bar\chi$ of $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$ factors uniquely as $\bar\chi = \prod_v \bar\chi_v$, where $\bar\chi_v$ is a genuine character of $\overline{T(k_v)}$, trivial on $T(\mathcal{O}_v)^*$ for almost all v. Conversely, every such family defines a genuine character of $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$. The same holds for unitary characters.

Proof. (a) The groups are abelian, so Schur's lemma applies; for unitary representations of locally compact abelian groups this is standard, and for admissible representations Schur's lemma holds because they have countable dimension. Since μ_2 is central, it acts by a character, and that character is the identity because the representation is genuine.

(b) μ_2 is a closed subgroup of the locally compact abelian group $\overline{T(F)}$, so the character $\zeta \mapsto \zeta$ of μ_2 extends [Ro]. The quotient of two genuine characters is trivial on μ_2, hence is the pull-back of a character of $T(F)$.

(c) Put $\bar\chi_v = \bar\chi \circ \iota_v$, where ι_v is the inclusion of $\overline{T(k_v)}$. Since $\bar\chi$ is continuous, its kernel contains an open subgroup, and hence contains $T(\mathcal{O}_v)^*$ for all v outside a finite set S. Every $x \in \overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$ is the image of some (x_v) with $x_v \in T(\mathcal{O}_v)^*$ for $v \notin S'$, and then $\bar\chi(x) = \prod_{v\in S'} \bar\chi_v(x_v)$. Conversely, $\prod_v \bar\chi_v$ is a character of the restricted product, and it is trivial on $\{(\zeta_v) \mid \prod \zeta_v = 1\}$ because each $\bar\chi_v$ is genuine. So it descends to $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})}$. □

This replaces Lemma 3.1 of the 1995 notes, which cited [Ge2] for factorizability of genuine representations of the restricted product. For $n = 2$ the statement concerns the quotient and needs no citation.

Let $X_T = T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$. It is a compact abelian group, an extension of the compact group $T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1$ by μ_2; μ_2 injects into X_T because $T(\mathbb{Q})$ meets μ_2 trivially in $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$. Let $\Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)$ be the set of genuine characters of $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ that are trivial on $T(\mathbb{Q})$, i.e. the genuine characters of X_T.

Theorem 3.2. *(a)* $L^2(X_T)_{\mathrm{gen}} = \widehat{\bigoplus}_{\bar\chi\in\Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)} \mathbb{C}\,\bar\chi$, *each character occurring with multiplicity one.*

(b) $\Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)$ *is not empty. For any* $\bar\chi_0 \in \Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)$, *the map* $\chi \mapsto \bar\chi_0\cdot(\chi\circ p)$ *is a bijection from the characters of* $T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1$ *onto* $\Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)$. *Replacing* $\bar\chi_0$ *by another element changes this bijection by a translation of* $(T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1)^\wedge$.

(c) For $T = A$, *the character* χ_ψ *of Lemma 3.3 lies in* $\Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_A)$; *it depends only on the fixed additive character* ψ *of* $\mathbb{A}_k/k$.

Proof. (a) Peter–Weyl for the compact abelian group X_T: $L^2(X_T)$ is the Hilbert sum of its characters, each once, and the genuine subspace is spanned by the genuine ones. (b) Apply Lemma 3.1(b) to the closed subgroup μ_2 of X_T; the second sentence follows as in that lemma. (c) is Lemma 3.3(c). □

Theorem 3.2 is the $n = 2$ form of Theorem 3.2 of the 1995 notes, restated as a correspondence of automorphic spectra. The 1995 statement matches genuine representations with characters χ^N, $N = n/\gcd(n,2)$; for $n = 2$, $N = 1$, and the matching requires the choice of $\bar\chi_0$, which the 1995 text did not make. The choice cannot be avoided:

Example 3.A. Let $k = \mathbb{Q}$, and let $\varepsilon \in A(\mathbb{A})^1$ be $a(-1)$ at the real place and 1 at every finite place. By Lemma 2.2(e) any lift $\tilde\varepsilon$ satisfies $\tilde\varepsilon^2 = (1,(-1,-1)_\infty) = (1,-1)$. So every genuine character $\bar\chi$ of $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})^1}$ has $\bar\chi(\tilde\varepsilon) = \pm i$, and no genuine character is of the form $(\chi\circ p)\cdot\mathrm{sgn}$ for a splitting $A(\mathbb{A})^1 \to \overline{A(\mathbb{A})^1}$; indeed no such splitting exists.

For the split torus there is a canonical choice, given by Weil indices [We64]. Let $\psi = \prod_v \psi_v$ be the nontrivial character of $\mathbb{A}_k/k$ fixed in Section 2.2. For $a \in k_v^\times$ let $\gamma_v(a) \in \mu_8$ be the Weil index of the character $x \mapsto \psi_v(ax^2)$ of k_v, normalized by

$$\int_{k_v} \psi_v(ax^2)\,dx = \gamma_v(a)\,|2a|_v^{-1/2} \tag{3.2}$$

(self-dual measure; for v finite the integral is the limit over the lattices $\varpi^{-M}\mathcal{O}_v$, $M \to \infty$).

Lemma 3.3 (Weil [We64]). *(a) $\gamma_v(a)$ depends only on the class of a in $k_v^\times/k_v^{\times 2}$, and $\gamma_v(ab)\gamma_v(1) = \gamma_v(a)\gamma_v(b)(a,b)_v$.*

(b) If v is finite and non-dyadic and ψ_v is unramified, then $\gamma_v(u) = \gamma_v(1) = 1$ for $u \in \mathcal{O}_v^\times$. For $a \in k^\times$, $\prod_v \gamma_v(a) = 1$.

(c) Hence $\chi_{\psi,v}(a(t),\zeta) = \zeta\,\gamma_v(t)/\gamma_v(1)$ is a genuine character of $\overline{A(k_v)}$, trivial on $A(\mathcal{O}_v)^* = A(\mathcal{O}_v)\times\{1\}$ for almost all v, and $\chi_\psi = \prod_v \chi_{\psi,v}$ is a genuine character of $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$ trivial on $A(\mathbb{Q})$. Its restriction to $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})^1}$ lies in $\Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_A)$.

(d) For $b \in k^\times$ and $\psi_b(x) = \psi(bx)$, $\chi_{\psi_b} = \chi_\psi \cdot \big(a(t) \mapsto \prod_v (b,t_v)_v\big)$.

Proof. (a) and (b) are due to Weil [We64, §§14, 28]. (c) By (a), $\chi_{\psi,v}(a(t_1),1)\chi_{\psi,v}(a(t_2),1) = (t_1,t_2)_v\,\chi_{\psi,v}(a(t_1t_2),1) = \chi_{\psi,v}((a(t_1),1)(a(t_2),1))$, using the group law (3.1). Unramifiedness is (b), and triviality on $(a(t),1)$, $t \in k^\times$, is the product formula in (b) applied to $\gamma(t)$ and to $\gamma(1)$. (d) $\psi_{b,v}(ax^2) = \psi_v(abx^2)$, so $\gamma_{\psi_b,v}(t)/\gamma_{\psi_b,v}(1) = \gamma_v(bt)/\gamma_v(b) = (\gamma_v(t)/\gamma_v(1))\,(b,t)_v$ by (a). □

Example 3.B. Let $k = \mathbb{Q}$, $\psi_p(x) = e^{2\pi i\{x\}_p}$ and $\psi_\infty(x) = e^{-2\pi i x}$, so ψ is trivial on $\mathbb{Q}$. Then $\gamma_\infty(a) = e^{-\pi i\,\mathrm{sgn}(a)/4}$, and for odd p, $\gamma_p(u) = 1$ and $\gamma_p(pu) = \left(\frac{u}{p}\right)\epsilon_p$ for $u \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times$, where $\epsilon_p = 1$ if $p \equiv 1 \pmod 4$ and $\epsilon_p = i$ if $p \equiv 3 \pmod 4$. So $\chi_{\psi,\infty}(a(-1),1) = i$, in accordance with Example 3.A, and $\chi_{\psi,p}(a(p),1) = \epsilon_p$ for odd p. The dyadic values are tabulated by the check script, which computes γ_v from (3.2) as a finite Gauss sum and verifies Lemma 3.3(a)–(c) at $v = \infty, 2, 3, 5, 7$ and the product formula on random $a \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$.

3.2 The trace formula

Let R be the right regular representation of $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ on $L^2(X_T)_{\mathrm{gen}}$, and for $f \in C_c^\infty(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1})_-$ put $R(f) = \int_{\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}} f(y)R(y)\,dy$ and

$$\bar\chi(f) = \int_{\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}} f(y)\bar\chi(y)\,dy, \qquad \bar\chi \in \Pi(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}).$$

The integrand $f\bar\chi$ is invariant under μ_2, so $\bar\chi(f)$ is an integral over $T(\mathbb{A})^1$; if $\bar\chi$ were trivial on μ_2 instead, the integral would vanish.

Theorem 3.4. *Let $f \in C_c^\infty(\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1})_-$.*

(a) $R(f)$ is the integral operator on $L^2(X_T)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ with kernel

$$K_f(x,y) = \sum_{\delta \in T(\mathbb{Q})} f(x^{-1}\delta y),$$

and $R(f)\bar\chi = \bar\chi(f)\,\bar\chi$ for $\bar\chi \in \Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)$.

(b) $R(f)$ is of trace class, and

$$\sum_{\bar\chi \in \Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)} \bar\chi(f) = \operatorname{tr} R(f) = \int_{X_T} K_f(x,x)\,dx = \mathrm{vol}\big(T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1\big) \sum_{\delta \in T(\mathbb{Q})} f(\delta), \tag{3.3}$$

the sum on the left converging absolutely.

Proof. (a) For $\varphi \in L^2(X_T)_{\mathrm{gen}}$,

$$(R(f)\varphi)(x) = \int_{\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}} f(y)\varphi(xy)\,dy = \int_{\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}} f(x^{-1}y)\varphi(y)\,dy = \int_{X_T} \sum_{\delta\in T(\mathbb{Q})} f(x^{-1}\delta y)\varphi(y)\,dy,$$

because $\varphi(\delta y) = \varphi(y)$. For $\varphi = \bar\chi$ the first expression is $\bar\chi(x)\bar\chi(f)$.

(b) The group is abelian, so $f(x^{-1}\delta x) = f(\delta)$, and $\int_{X_T} K_f(x,x)\,dx = \mathrm{vol}(X_T)\sum_\delta f(\delta)$ with $\mathrm{vol}(X_T) = \mathrm{vol}(T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1)$ since μ_2 has volume 1. The function $F(x) = \sum_\delta f(\delta x)$ is smooth on X_T (the sum is locally finite, $T(\mathbb{Q})$ being discrete), so its Fourier series converges absolutely; its Fourier coefficient at $\bar\chi$ is $\int_{X_T} F\bar\chi = \bar\chi(f)$, which vanishes unless $\bar\chi$ is genuine. Evaluating the Fourier series at $x = 1$ gives the outer equality of (3.3), i.e. Poisson summation. Since $R(f)$ is diagonal in the orthonormal basis $\mathrm{vol}(X_T)^{-1/2}\bar\chi$ with summable eigenvalues $\bar\chi(f)$, it is of trace class with that trace. □

Theorem 3.4 replaces Theorems 3.8 and 3.9 of the 1995 notes. For $n = 2$ every conjugacy class in $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ is a point and every centralizer is the whole group, so the orbital integrals there reduce to the values $f(\delta)$. Here $f(\delta)$ means f at the image $(\delta, \kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\delta))$ of δ; for $T = A$ it is $f(a(\delta), 1)$.

The trace formula for $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ is literally Poisson summation on $T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1$, after multiplying by a genuine automorphic character:

Lemma 3.5. *Fix $\bar\chi_0 \in \Pi_{\mathrm{aut}}(X_T)$ with local components $\bar\chi_{0,v}$, as in Lemma 3.1(c). For an anti-genuine $\bar f$ on $\overline{T(\mathbb{A})^1}$ (resp. $\overline{T(k_v)}$) define f on $T(\mathbb{A})^1$ (resp. $T_k(k_v)$) by $f(t) = \bar f(\tilde t)\bar\chi_0(\tilde t)$ (resp. $\bar\chi_{0,v}$), $\tilde t$ any lift of t.*

(a) $\bar f \mapsto f$ is well defined, bijective from $C_c^\infty(\overline{T(\cdot)})_-$ onto $C_c^\infty(T(\cdot))$, and carries convolution to convolution.

(b) At every v where $\bar\chi_{0,v}$ is trivial on $T(\mathcal{O}_v)^*$ (almost all v), it carries $e_{T,v}$ to the characteristic function of $T_k(k_v)\cap K_v$, which is the unit of the Hecke algebra of $T_k(k_v)$ when $T_k(k_v)\cap K_v$ has volume 1.

(c) $f(\delta) = \bar f(\delta)$ for $\delta \in T(\mathbb{Q})$, and $(\bar\chi_0\cdot(\chi\circ p))(\bar f) = \hat f(\chi) := \int_{T(\mathbb{A})^1} f(t)\chi(t)\,dt$ for every character χ of $T(\mathbb{A})^1$.

Consequently (3.3) for $\bar f$ is the Poisson summation formula $\sum_\chi \hat f(\chi) = \mathrm{vol}(T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1)\sum_{\delta\in T(\mathbb{Q})} f(\delta)$ for f, χ running over the characters of $T(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T(\mathbb{A})^1$.

Proof. (a) $\bar f\bar\chi_0$ is μ_2-invariant because $\bar f$ is anti-genuine and $\bar\chi_0$ genuine, and the inverse map is $f \mapsto (f\circ p)\bar\chi_0^{-1}$. For convolution, $(\bar f_1 * \bar f_2)(x)\bar\chi_0(x) = \int \bar f_1(y)\bar\chi_0(y)\,\bar f_2(y^{-1}x)\bar\chi_0(y^{-1}x)\,dy$, and the integrand is μ_2-invariant in y, so the integral over the cover equals the integral over T. (b) is immediate. (c) $\bar\chi_0$ is trivial on $T(\mathbb{Q})$; the second identity is the definition, the integrand being μ_2-invariant. □

This replaces Lemmas 3.11 and 3.12 and the argument through Claims 1 and 2 of the 1995 notes. The local maps $\bar f_v \mapsto f_v$ involve no sum over $T(\mathbb{Q}_p)_\delta\backslash T(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ and no factor $s_{\mathbb{A}}(\delta)$, because there is no conjugation. Together with Theorem 3.4 they show that the correspondence $\chi \leftrightarrow \bar\chi_0\cdot(\chi\circ p)$ of Theorem 3.2 matches the two trace formulas term by term.

3.3 Distributions for Section 6

Let S be a finite set of places of $\mathbb{Q}$ and let $\overline{A(\mathbb{A}_S)}$ be the cover of $A(\mathbb{A}_S) = \prod_{p\in S} A(\mathbb{Q}_p)$ defined by $\prod_{p\in S}\beta_p$. Let $\mathcal{H}(\overline{A(\mathbb{A}_S)})$ be the algebra of functions $\bigotimes_{p\in S} f_p$, $f_p \in C_c^\infty(\overline{A(\mathbb{Q}_p)})_-$, and the analogous algebra $\mathcal{H}(\overline{A(\mathbb{A})})$ of Section 3.1. For a class $\mathcal{O} = \{\delta\}$ of $A(\mathbb{Q})$ (a single element, since the cover is abelian) and $\bar\chi \in \Pi_u(\overline{A(\mathbb{A}_S)})$, put

$$I^A_{\mathcal{O}}(f) = f(a(\delta), 1), \qquad I^A_{\bar\chi}(f) = \bar\chi(f) = \int_{\overline{A(\mathbb{A}_S)}} f(y)\bar\chi(y)\,dy, \tag{3.4}$$

for $f \in \mathcal{H}(\overline{A(\mathbb{A}_S)})$, and likewise over $\mathbb{A}$. Here $(a(\delta), 1)$ is the image of δ under the rational splitting (Lemma 2.6(b)). Both are invariant distributions: the cover is abelian, so conjugation acts trivially.

Remark 2026.6. For general n the cover of A is not abelian: by the computation in Lemma 2.2(f), $\overline{A(F)}$ is a Heisenberg-type group whose commutator pairing is $(t_1, t_2)_n^{-2}$. Its genuine irreducible representations are then parametrized by genuine characters of its center, the preimage of A^N with $N = n/\gcd(n, 2)$. Matching them with characters of A^N requires a splitting over A^N, and the global argument requires a Hasse principle for N-th powers, which holds when $\mu_N \subset k$. These are referee items II.1–II.4; none of them arises for $n = 2$, and this section does not treat $n > 2$.

Remark 2026.7. The script `checks/sec3_n2_check.py` verifies: that the 1995 cocycle on A equals (3.1); that γ_v, computed from (3.2), is an eighth root of unity, depends only on the square class, is 1 on units at $p = 3, 5, 7$, and satisfies Lemma 3.3(a); that $\chi_{\psi,v}$ respects the group law (Lemma 3.3(c)) at $v = \infty, 2, 3, 5, 7$; the product formula of Lemma 3.3(b) for random $a \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$; the odd-p values of Example 3.B; and Example 3.A. The rest of the section is proved in the text.

4 The geometric side

This section computes the geometric side of the trace formula for $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$, class by class. The general theory is due to Arthur [A2, A3, A12] for connected reductive groups and to Li [Li I] for covering groups; we specialize it to the double cover of $G = \mathrm{Res}_{k/\mathbb{Q}} SL(2)$. For this group one inequality between heights (Lemma 4.3) makes the reduction theory explicit, with truncation parameter $T_0 = 0$. With it, every step of Arthur's coarse expansion can be checked directly, and each class contributes a polynomial in T of degree at most one that we write down (Theorem 4.5, Propositions 4.6, 4.7 and 4.8). The new parts are the corrected weight $2T + v_A$ for hyperbolic classes, the unipotent contribution of the central classes, given as the finite part of a zeta integral, and the local distribution $J_A(z, f)$ at a central element (Lemma 4.10). Section 4.5 states the fine expansion [A12, Li I] in the form that Sections 5–7 use.

Throughout, $G(\mathbb{Q})$ is identified with its image in $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ under Lemma 2.6(a), and $N(\mathbb{A})$ with $N(\mathbb{A}) \times 1$; on $B(\mathbb{Q})$ the two identifications agree, and $b \mapsto (b, 1)$ (Lemma 2.6(b)). Test functions are anti-genuine (Section 2.1.4). We write $w = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \in G(\mathbb{Q})$, and $d = [k : \mathbb{Q}]$.

4.1 Equivalence classes

Following [A2, §2], call $\gamma, \gamma' \in G(\mathbb{Q})$ *equivalent* if their semisimple parts are $G(\mathbb{Q})$-conjugate, and let $\mathcal{C}$ be the set of equivalence classes. A class is *unramified* [A2, p. 949] if it consists of

semisimple elements.

Lemma 4.1. *The classes $\mathcal{O} \in \mathcal{C}$ are of three kinds.*

(a) Central*: for $z \in \{\pm 1\}$, $\mathcal{O}_z = \{zu \mid u \in G(\mathbb{Q})$ unipotent$\}$. It is not unramified: it contains z and $z\,n(\nu)$, $\nu \in k^\times$.*

(b) Hyperbolic*: the $G(\mathbb{Q})$-conjugacy class of $\mu = a(t)$, $t \in k^\times \smallsetminus \{\pm 1\}$. It contains $a(t^{-1}) = w\mu w^{-1}$ and meets $A(\mathbb{Q})$ in $\{a(t), a(t^{-1})\}$; it is determined by $\{t, t^{-1}\}$. The centralizer of μ is A.*

(c) Elliptic*: the $G(\mathbb{Q})$-conjugacy class of a regular $\mu \in G(\mathbb{Q})$ whose characteristic polynomial is irreducible over k. Its centralizer is a maximal torus $T_\mu = \mathrm{Res}_{k/\mathbb{Q}} T_k$, anisotropic over $\mathbb{Q}$, and $\mathcal{O} \cap A(\mathbb{Q}) = \emptyset$.*

Classes of kinds (b) and (c) are unramified. In all three cases the centralizer of (the image of) μ in $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ is the full preimage $\overline{G_\mu(\mathbb{A})}$, which is abelian in cases (b) and (c).

Proof. An element of $SL(2,k)$ with semisimple part ± 1 is $\pm$ a unipotent element. A regular semisimple element with eigenvalues in k is $GL(2,k)$-conjugate to $a(t)$, and then $SL(2,k)$-conjugate to it, because $\mathrm{diag}(y,1)$ centralizes $a(t)$. The centralizers are standard. For the cover: if $h \in G_\mu(\mathbb{A})$, lifts of h and μ commute by Lemma 2.6(d)–(e) (the argument of Lemma 2.2(g), applied to the abelian group generated by h and μ); conversely the centralizer in $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ maps into $G_\mu(\mathbb{A})$. □

The 1995 text lists the centralizer G for $\gamma = \pm 1$ among the centralizers of semisimple classes that are "anisotropic modulo the center" and calls all such classes unramified. Neither holds for ± 1: G is isotropic, and $\mathcal{O}_{\pm 1}$ contains $\pm$(unipotent) elements. For general n the centralizer of a lift of a split γ can be smaller than the preimage of A, and then the genuine orbital integral vanishes (`book3b.tex`, Lemma 5.2). For $n = 2$ this does not happen, by the last sentence of the lemma.

4.2 Kernels, heights and truncation

Let $f \in \mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})$. We use Arthur's convention: R is the right regular representation on $L^2(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})_{\mathrm{gen}}$, the space of φ with $\varphi(\gamma x \zeta) = \zeta\varphi(x)$, and $(R(f)\varphi)(x) = \int_{\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} f(y)\varphi(xy)\,dy$. The integrand is invariant under $y \mapsto y\zeta$ because f is anti-genuine. For a standard parabolic $P = MN_P \in \{B, G\}$ and $\mathcal{O} \in \mathcal{C}$ put

$$K_P(x,y) = \sum_{\gamma \in M(\mathbb{Q})} \int_{N_P(\mathbb{A})} f(x^{-1}\gamma n y)\,dn, \qquad K_{P,\mathcal{O}}(x,y) = \sum_{\gamma \in M(\mathbb{Q}) \cap \mathcal{O}} \int_{N_P(\mathbb{A})} f(x^{-1}\gamma n y)\,dn, \tag{4.1}$$

$$J_{P,\mathcal{O}}(x,y) = \sum_{\mu \in M(\mathbb{Q}) \cap \mathcal{O}} \sum_{\nu \in N_{P,\mu_s}(\mathbb{Q})\backslash N_P(\mathbb{Q})} \int_{N_{P,\mu_s}(\mathbb{A})} f(x^{-1}\nu^{-1}\mu n \nu y)\,dn, \tag{4.2}$$

where $\mu = \mu_s\mu_u$ is the Jordan decomposition and N_{P,μ_s} the centralizer of μ_s in N_P. For $P = G$ these are $K_G = \sum_{\gamma \in G(\mathbb{Q})} f(x^{-1}\gamma y)$ and $K_{G,\mathcal{O}} = J_{G,\mathcal{O}} = \sum_{\gamma \in \mathcal{O}} f(x^{-1}\gamma y)$.

Lemma 4.2. *The sums (4.1) and (4.2) are finite, uniformly for x, y in compact sets. $K_P(x,y) = \sum_{\mathcal{O}} K_{P,\mathcal{O}}(x,y)$, and K_P is the kernel of $R_P(f)$, where R_P is the right regular representation on $L^2(N_P(\mathbb{A})M(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})_{\mathrm{gen}}$.*

Proof. $G(\mathbb{Q})$ is discrete in $G(\mathbb{A})$ and f has compact support modulo μ_2, so only finitely many γ contribute for x, y in a compact set; the integrals over $N_P(\mathbb{A})$ are over compact sets for the same reason. For upper triangular $b_1, b_2 \in B(\mathbb{A})$ with lower right entries d_1, d_2, (2.1) and $\kappa_v|_B \equiv 1$ give $\sigma_{\mathbb{A}}(b_1, b_2) = \prod_v (d_2, d_1)_v$, which is 1 when $d_1, d_2 \in k^\times$. So $b \mapsto (b, 1)$ is a homomorphism on $N(\mathbb{A})A(\mathbb{Q})$, and $N_P(\mathbb{A})M(\mathbb{Q})$ is a subgroup of $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$. For φ in that space,

$$(R_P(f)\varphi)(x) = \int_{\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} f(x^{-1}y)\varphi(y)\,dy = \int_{N_P(\mathbb{A})M(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} \sum_{\gamma\in M(\mathbb{Q})} \int_{N_P(\mathbb{A})} f(x^{-1}\gamma n y)\,dn\ \varphi(y)\,dy,$$

using $\varphi(\gamma n y) = \varphi(y)$. The decomposition over $\mathcal{O}$ is a regrouping of the finite sum. □

This is Lemma 4.1 of the 1995 notes with $K_P = \sum_{\mathcal{O}} K_{P,\mathcal{O}}$ (not $\sum K_{\mathcal{O}}$) and with one kernel convention, $f(x^{-1}\gamma y)$, throughout; no passage to the archimedean place is needed for the convergence.

Heights. For a row vector $u = (c, d) \in k_v^2$ put $\|u\|_v = \max(|c|_v, |d|_v)$ if v is finite and $\|u\|_v = (|c|^2 + |d|^2)^{[k_v:\mathbb{R}]/2}$ if v is archimedean, and for $u \in \mathbb{A}_k^2$ put $\|u\| = \prod_v \|u_v\|_v$. Then $\|\lambda u\|_v = |\lambda|_v\|u\|_v$, and $\|e_2 k\|_v = 1$ for $k \in K_v$, where $e_2 = (0, 1)$. Recall $H = H_B$ from Lemma 2.8.

Lemma 4.3. *(a) For $x \in \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ with image $g \in G(\mathbb{A})$, $H(x) = -\log\|e_2 g\|$. The same holds at a single place: $H_v(g) = -\log\|e_2 g\|_v$ for $g \in SL(2, k_v)$.*

(b) If $\gamma \in G(\mathbb{Q}) \smallsetminus B(\mathbb{Q})$, then

$$H(x) + H(\gamma x) \le 0 \qquad (x \in \overline{G(\mathbb{A})}).$$

Consequently, if $T \ge 0$, then for each x there is at most one $\delta \in B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})$ with $H(\delta x) > T$.

(c) $H(ax) = H(a) + H(x)$ and $H(wax) = -H(a) + H(wx)$ for $a \in \overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$. Hence

$$v_A(x) = -H(x) - H(wx) \tag{4.3}$$

is left $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$-invariant, right $\overline{K_0}$-invariant, and $v_A(x) \ge 0$.

Proof. (a) If $g = n\,a(t)\,k$, then $e_2 g = t^{-1} e_2 k$, so $\|e_2 g\| = |t|^{-1} = e^{-H(x)}$. The local statement is the same computation.

(b) Let $e_2\gamma = (c, d)$, with $c \ne 0$ since $\gamma \notin B(\mathbb{Q})$. The matrix with rows $e_2 g$ and $e_2\gamma g$ has determinant $\det\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \det g = -c$. At each place, $|\det(u_1; u_2)|_v \le \|u_1\|_v\|u_2\|_v$: this is the ultrametric inequality at finite places and Hadamard's inequality (squared at complex places) at archimedean ones. Taking the product over v, $1 = |c|_{\mathbb{A}_k} \le \|e_2 g\|\,\|e_2\gamma g\| = e^{-H(x)-H(\gamma x)}$ by (a) and the product formula. If $\delta_1 \ne \delta_2$ in $B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})$ both had $H(\delta_i x) > T \ge 0$, then (b), applied to $\delta_1 x$ and $\gamma = \delta_2\delta_1^{-1} \notin B(\mathbb{Q})$, would give $0 < 2T < H(\delta_1 x) + H(\delta_2 x) \le 0$.

(c) The first identity is Lemma 2.5(a). For the second, $wa\,w^{-1} = a^{-1}$, so $H(wax) = H(a^{-1} \cdot wx) = -H(a) + H(wx)$. Right K_0-invariance is Lemma 2.5(b), and $v_A \ge 0$ is (b) with $\gamma = w$. □

Lemma 4.3(b) replaces Lemma 4.2 of the 1995 notes (which has an unused N and only the bound ≤ 1, cited from [A2]); compare [A2, Lemma 5.1]. Reduction theory [Go] gives a Siegel set $\mathfrak{S} = \{(n,1)\,\tilde{a}\,\tilde{k} \mid n \in \omega,\ H(\tilde{a}) > -c,\ p(\tilde{a}) \in \Omega\, A_B(\mathbb{R})^0,\ \tilde{k} \in \overline{K_0}\}$, with $\omega \subset N(\mathbb{A})$ and $\Omega \subset A(\mathbb{A})^1$ compact and $c \ge 0$, such that $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})} = G(\mathbb{Q})\mathfrak{S}$. In the coordinates $x = nak$ the measure is $\delta_B(a)^{-1} dn\, da\, dk$ by (2.9) (the 1995 notes have $\delta(a)$), and $\mathfrak{S}$ has finite volume. The constants $u \ge 1/2$ and $T_0 > \sqrt{3}/2$ of the 1995 text are the classical ones for $SL(2,\mathbb{Z})$ over $\mathbb{Q}$ and play no role below.

Truncation. Let $\hat{\tau}_B = \tau_B$ be the characteristic function of $(0,\infty)$ (Section 2.1.3), $\hat{\tau}_G = 1$, and $\dim A_G = 0$, $\dim A_B = 1$. For $T \in \mathbb{R} \cong \mathfrak{a}$ put

$$k^T(x,f) = K_G(x,x) - \sum_{\delta \in B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})} K_B(\delta x, \delta x)\, \hat{\tau}_B(H(\delta x) - T), \tag{4.4}$$

and define $k^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x,f)$ and $j^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x,f)$ in the same way with $K_{P,\mathcal{O}}$, respectively $J_{P,\mathcal{O}}$, in place of K_P. By Lemma 4.3(b), for $T \ge 0$ the sum over δ has at most one nonzero term. Let $F^G(x,T)$ be the characteristic function of $\{x \mid H(\delta x) \le T \text{ for all } \delta \in G(\mathbb{Q})\}$; its support is compact modulo $G(\mathbb{Q})$ by reduction theory [Go].

Lemma 4.4. *Let $T \ge 0$. Then $F^G(x,T) + \sum_{\delta \in B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})} \tau_B(H(\delta x) - T) = 1$, and*

$$k^T(x,f) = F^G(x,T)\, K_G(x,x) + \sum_{\delta \in B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})} \tau_B(H(\delta x) - T)\big(K_G(\delta x, \delta x) - K_B(\delta x, \delta x)\big). \tag{4.5}$$

Proof. The first identity says that either $H(\delta x) \le T$ for all δ, or $H(\delta x) > T$ for exactly one coset, which is Lemma 4.3(b). Multiply it by $K_G(x,x) = K_G(\delta x, \delta x)$ and subtract the δ-sum of (4.4). □

This is Lemma 4.3 and (4.2) of the 1995 notes, there with two parameters $T_0 > T_1$ in reversed roles and with a function F^B that is identically 1 for $SL(2)$. In general [A2, §6], [Ar05, §8], the partition holds for T sufficiently regular; here $T \ge 0$ suffices.

4.3 The coarse geometric expansion

Let dx be a Haar measure on $G(\mathbb{A})$ with $dx = \delta_B(a)^{-1} dn\, da\, dk$ for $x = nak$ as in (2.9), where dk gives K_0 volume 1, dn gives $N(\mathbb{Q})\backslash N(\mathbb{A})$ volume 1, and da is a Haar measure on $A(\mathbb{A}) \cong \mathbb{A}_k^\times$, written $d^\times t$ for $a = a(t)$. On covers μ_2 has volume 1. Write $A(\mathbb{A}) = A(\mathbb{A})^1 \times A_B(\mathbb{R})^0$, where $A_B(\mathbb{R})^0 = \{a(u) \mid u \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}\}$ (u embedded diagonally in $k \otimes \mathbb{R}$), let dX be Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R} \cong \mathfrak{a}$ transported to $A_B(\mathbb{R})^0$ by H, and let da^1 be the Haar measure on $A(\mathbb{A})^1$ with $da = da^1\, dX$. Put

$$c_k = \mathrm{vol}\big(A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash A(\mathbb{A})^1\big) = \mathrm{vol}\big(k^\times \backslash \mathbb{A}_k^1\big).$$

Theorem 4.5. *Let $f \in \mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})$ and $T \ge 0$.*

(a) Only finitely many $\mathcal{O} \in \mathcal{C}$ have $k^T_{\mathcal{O}}(\cdot, f) \not\equiv 0$, and $k^T(x,f) = \sum_{\mathcal{O}} k^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x,f)$.

(b) Each $k^T_{\mathcal{O}}(\cdot,f)$ and each $j^T_{\mathcal{O}}(\cdot,f)$ is absolutely integrable over $G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$, and

$$J^T_{\mathcal{O}}(f) := \int_{G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} k^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x,f)\, dx = \int_{G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} j^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x,f)\, dx.$$

(c) Hence $k^T(\cdot,f)$ is absolutely integrable, and $J^T(f) := \int k^T(x,f)\,dx = \sum_{\mathcal{O}} J^T_{\mathcal{O}}(f)$.

(d) Each $J^T_{\mathcal{O}}(f)$ is a polynomial in T of degree at most 1, given by Propositions 4.6, 4.7 and 4.8.

We put $J_{\mathcal{O}}(f) = J^0_{\mathcal{O}}(f)$ and $J(f) = J^0(f) = \sum_{\mathcal{O}} J_{\mathcal{O}}(f)$. In general one defines $J_{\mathcal{O}}$ as the value at $T=0$ of the polynomial $J^T_{\mathcal{O}}$, which is known only for T sufficiently regular [A3, Ar05]. Here the integral itself converges at $T=0$, so the two definitions agree. Theorem 4.5 is the case of $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ of Arthur's coarse expansion [A2, §§7–8], [A3], extended to covers by Li [Li I]; for this group we prove it directly. It replaces Lemma 4.4, Corollaries 4.5–4.7, Proposition 4.8 and Corollary 4.9 of the 1995 notes. Their proof of Lemma 4.4 omits the terms $\gamma \notin B(\mathbb{Q})$ and the sum over $\mu \in A(\mathbb{Q})$, and the per-class bounds in Corollaries 4.5–4.7 are not established there. Proposition 4.8 claims polynomiality for $K^T_{\mathcal{O}}$ and $J^T_{\mathcal{O}}$ separately, without a proof. Part (b) shows that for this group both integrals exist and coincide, and part (d) gives the polynomials.

Proposition 4.6 (Hyperbolic classes)**.** *Let $\mathcal{O}$ be the class of $\mu = a(t)$, $t \in k^\times \smallsetminus \{\pm 1\}$, and $T \geq 0$. Then*

$$j^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x,f) = \sum_{\eta \in A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})} f(x^{-1}\eta^{-1}\mu\eta x)\big(1 - \hat\tau_B(H(\eta x) - T) - \hat\tau_B(H(w\eta x) - T)\big), \tag{4.6}$$

and

$$J^T_{\mathcal{O}}(f) = c_k \int_{\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} f(y^{-1}\mu y)\,\big(2T + v_A(y)\big)\,dy, \tag{4.7}$$

with $v_A(y) = -H(y) - H(wy) \geq 0$ as in (4.3). The integral converges absolutely.

Proof. Here $\mathcal{O} \cap A(\mathbb{Q}) = \{\mu, \mu^{-1}\}$ and $N_{\mu_s} = 1$, so

$$J_{B,\mathcal{O}}(y,y) = \sum_{\mu' \in \{\mu,\mu^{-1}\}} \sum_{\nu \in N(\mathbb{Q})} f(y^{-1}\nu^{-1}\mu'\nu y).$$

As δ runs over $B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})$ and ν over $N(\mathbb{Q})$, $\eta = \nu\delta$ runs over $A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})$, and $H(\nu\delta x) = H(\delta x)$. Writing $\mu^{-1} = w^{-1}\mu w$ and replacing η by $w^{-1}\eta$ in the μ^{-1}-term (note that $H(w^{-1}y) = H(-wy) = H(wy)$) gives (4.6), since $K_{G,\mathcal{O}}(x,x) = \sum_\eta f(x^{-1}\eta^{-1}\mu\eta x)$.

By Lemma 4.3(b), for $T \geq 0$ the two $\hat\tau_B$ in (4.6) are never both 1, so the bracket is 0 or 1. Unfolding, and writing $x = \tilde a y$ with $\tilde a \in \overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$,

$$\int |j^T_{\mathcal{O}}| \leq \int_{\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} |f(y^{-1}\mu y)| \int_{A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}} \big(1 - \hat\tau_B(H(\tilde a y) - T) - \hat\tau_B(H(w\tilde a y) - T)\big)\,d\tilde a\,dy,$$

with equality if $f \geq 0$, and we used $f(y^{-1}\tilde a^{-1}\mu\tilde a y) = f(y^{-1}\mu y)$, because $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}$ is abelian (Lemma 2.6(e)). Put $X = H(\tilde a)$, $h_1 = H(y)$, $h_2 = H(wy)$; by Lemma 4.3(c) the bracket is $1 - \mathbf{1}[X + h_1 > T] - \mathbf{1}[-X + h_2 > T]$, whose integral over $X \in \mathbb{R}$ is $2T - h_1 - h_2 = 2T + v_A(y)$. The integral over $A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash A(\mathbb{A})^1$ gives c_k. This proves (4.7) for $\int j^T_{\mathcal{O}}$ and its absolute convergence: in the coordinates $y = n(z)k$ on $\overline{A(\mathbb{A})}\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ (measure $dz\,dk$), $y^{-1}\mu y = k^{-1}\mu\, n((1-t^{-2})z)k$, so z runs over a compact set and $v_A(n(z)k)$ is bounded there (Lemma 4.9).

It remains to show $\int k^T_{\mathcal{O}} = \int j^T_{\mathcal{O}}$. By definition

$$k^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x) - j^T_{\mathcal{O}}(x) = \sum_\delta \hat\tau_B(H(\delta x) - T)\,\big(J_{B,\mathcal{O}} - K_{B,\mathcal{O}}\big)(\delta x, \delta x).$$

Let $x=(n(u_0),1)\,\tilde a\,\tilde k$ with $p(\tilde a)=a(s)$. For $\mu'=a(t')$ one has $n(-\nu)\mu' n(\nu)=\mu' n((1-t'^{-2})\nu)$, a bijection of $N(\mathbb{Q})$, and $\tilde a^{-1}\mu'(n(z),1)\tilde a=\mu'(n(s^{-2}z),1)$ (Lemma 2.2(h)). So with $g_{\mu'}(z)=f(\tilde k^{-1}\mu'(n(z),1)\tilde k)$ and $c=(1-t'^{-2})u_0$,

$$(J_{B,\mathcal O}-K_{B,\mathcal O})(x,x)=\sum_{\mu'}\Big(\sum_{\nu\in k} g_{\mu'}(s^{-2}(\nu+c))-\int_{\mathbb{A}_k} g_{\mu'}(s^{-2}(z+c))\,dz\Big).$$

By Poisson summation over $k\subset\mathbb{A}_k$ [Ta], this is $|s|^2\sum_{\mu'}\sum_{\nu\in k^\times}\hat g_{\mu'}(s^2\nu)\psi(\nu c)$, which is $O(|s|^{2-M})$ for every M, uniformly for $\tilde k\in\overline{K_0}$ and s in $\Omega\times\mathbb{R}_{\ge1}$, $\Omega\subset\mathbb{A}_k^1$ compact. Since $\delta_B(a)^{-1}=|s|^{-2}$, the function $\hat\tau_B(H(x)-T)(J_{B,\mathcal O}-K_{B,\mathcal O})(x,x)$ is absolutely integrable over $B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$, and unfolding is justified. Integrating first over $u_0\in k\backslash\mathbb{A}_k$ gives 0, because $\int_{k\backslash\mathbb{A}_k}\sum_{\nu\in k} g(s^{-2}(\nu+c))\,du_0=|1-t'^{-2}|_{\mathbb{A}_k}^{-1}\int_{\mathbb{A}_k} g(s^{-2}z)\,dz$ and $|1-t'^{-2}|_{\mathbb{A}_k}=1$ by the product formula. □

The 1995 weight $v_{\mathcal O}(x,T)=2(T-H(x))$ (referee item II.5) is not left $A(\mathbb{A})$-invariant; the w-term was lost in passing from the sum over δ in (4.3) to $\hat\tau_B(H(\eta x)-T)$ in (4.4). The weight $2T-\log\delta(x)-\log\delta(wx)$ of `book7d.tex` has the right shape but the wrong normalization, since $\log\delta_B=2H$ (item A.4). In the form (4.7), $J_{\mathcal O}(f)$ is c_k times Arthur's weighted orbital integral, v_A being the volume of the convex hull of $\{-H_B(y),-H_{\bar B}(y)\}$ with $H_{\bar B}(y)=-H(wy)$. For the measure on $\mathfrak a$ see Remark 2026.8.

Proposition 4.7 (Elliptic classes)**.** *Let $\mathcal O$ be elliptic, with $\mu\in\mathcal O$ and $T_\mu=G_\mu$. Then $k_{\mathcal O}^T=j_{\mathcal O}^T=K_{G,\mathcal O}(x,x)$ for every T, and*

$$J_{\mathcal O}(f)=J_{\mathcal O}^T(f)=\operatorname{vol}\big(T_\mu(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T_\mu(\mathbb{A})\big)\int_{\overline{T_\mu(\mathbb{A})}\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}} f(y^{-1}\mu y)\,dy,$$

the integral converging absolutely.

Proof. $\mathcal O\cap A(\mathbb{Q})=\emptyset$, so the B-terms vanish. Unfold $\sum_{\eta\in T_\mu(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})}$ and use that $\overline{T_\mu(\mathbb{A})}$ is abelian, so $f(y^{-1}\tilde t^{-1}\mu\tilde t y)=f(y^{-1}\mu y)$. The quotient $T_\mu(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T_\mu(\mathbb{A})$ is compact (T_μ is anisotropic, so $T_\mu(\mathbb{A})^1=T_\mu(\mathbb{A})$), and the orbit of μ is closed, so the orbital integral of the compactly supported $|f|$ converges. □

Central classes. For $z\in\{\pm1\}$ let $f_z(x)=f(zx)$, with z identified with its image $(z,1)$ in $\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}$ (Lemma 2.6(a), $\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\pm1)=1$). It is central, so $f_z\in\mathcal H(\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})$, and at almost all v its local component is again e_v, because $(-1,1)\in K_v^*$. For $f\in\mathcal H(\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})$ define a Schwartz–Bruhat function on $\mathbb{A}_k$ by

$$\Phi_f(y)=\int_{\overline{K_0}} f\big(\tilde k^{-1}(n(y),1)\tilde k\big)\,d\tilde k, \tag{4.8}$$

let $\hat\Phi_f$ be its Fourier transform with respect to ψ, and for $\operatorname{Re}s>1$ put

$$Z(f,s)=\int_{k^\times\backslash\mathbb{A}_k^\times}|t|^{-2s}\sum_{\nu\in k^\times}\Phi_f(t^{-2}\nu)\,d^\times t=\frac12\sum_{\xi\in k^\times/k^{\times2}}\int_{\mathbb{A}_k^\times}\Phi_f(\xi t^2)\,|t|^{2s}\,d^\times t. \tag{4.9}$$

For $f=\bigotimes_v f_v$ the last integral is the product of the local integrals $Z_v(\Phi_{f,v},\xi,s)=\int_{k_v^\times}\Phi_{f,v}(\xi t^2)|t|_v^{2s}d^\times t$, which are, at $s=1$, twice the local unipotent orbital integrals of f_v at $n(\xi)$ (Lemma 4.10(c)).

Proposition 4.8 (Central classes)**.** *Let $z \in \{\pm 1\}$. Then $k^T_{\mathcal{O}_z} = j^T_{\mathcal{O}_z}$, and $J^T_{\mathcal{O}_z}(f) = J^T_{\mathrm{unip}}(f_z)$, where for every $T \in \mathbb{R}$*

$$J^T_{\mathrm{unip}}(f) = \mathrm{vol}\big(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}\big) f(1) + c_k\, \hat{\Phi}_f(0)\, T + \operatorname*{FP}_{s=1} Z(f,s). \tag{4.10}$$

Here $Z(f,s)$, absolutely convergent for $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$, extends to a meromorphic function on $\mathbb{C}$ whose only possible poles are simple ones at $s = 1$ and $s = 0$; the residue at $s = 1$ is $c_k \hat{\Phi}_f(0)/2$, and $\mathrm{FP}_{s=1}$ denotes the constant term of the Laurent expansion. In particular

$$J_{\mathcal{O}_z}(f) = J_{\mathrm{unip}}(f_z), \qquad J_{\mathrm{unip}}(f) = \mathrm{vol}\big(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}\big) f(1) + \operatorname*{FP}_{s=1} Z(f,s).$$

Proof. Since z is central, $K_{P,\mathcal{O}_z}(x,y)$ for f equals $K_{P,\mathcal{O}_1}(x,y)$ for f_z, and likewise for J_P; and $J_{P,\mathcal{O}_1} = K_{P,\mathcal{O}_1}$ because $\mu_s = 1$ and $N_{P,1} = N_P$. So it suffices to treat $z = 1$. The nontrivial unipotent elements of $G(\mathbb{Q})$ are the $\delta^{-1} n(\nu)\delta$, $\delta \in B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash G(\mathbb{Q})$, $\nu \in k^\times$, each written once, so

$$k^T_{\mathcal{O}_1}(x) = f(1) + \sum_{\delta} \Big(F(\delta x) - \hat{\tau}_B(H(\delta x) - T)\, C(\delta x) \Big),$$

where $F(x) = \sum_{\nu \in k^\times} f(x^{-1} n(\nu) x)$ and $C(x) = \int_{N(\mathbb{A})} f(x^{-1} n x)\, dn$. For $x = (n_0, 1)\tilde{a}\tilde{k}$ with $p(\tilde{a}) = a(t)$ we have $x^{-1}(n(\nu),1)x = \tilde{k}^{-1}(n(t^{-2}\nu),1)\tilde{k}$, so F and C depend only on t and $\tilde{k}$. With $g_{\tilde{k}}(y) = f(\tilde{k}^{-1}(n(y),1)\tilde{k})$, Poisson summation gives

$$\delta_B(a)^{-1}\big(F - C\big)(x) = \sum_{\nu \in k^\times} \hat{g}_{\tilde{k}}(t^2\nu) - |t|^{-2} g_{\tilde{k}}(0),$$

which is integrable over $|t| > e^T$, uniformly in $\tilde{k}$; and $F(x) = 0$ once $|t|$ is small, because $g_{\tilde{k}}$ has compact support uniformly in $\tilde{k}$ and k is discrete in $\mathbb{A}_k$. Hence the three pieces $f(1)$, $\sum_\delta (1 - \hat{\tau}_B)F$ and $\sum_\delta \hat{\tau}_B(F - C)$ of $k^T_{\mathcal{O}_1}$ are absolutely integrable, and unfolding each over $B(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})} = N(\mathbb{Q})\backslash N(\mathbb{A}) \times A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash A(\mathbb{A}) \times \overline{K_0}$ gives, with $G(t) = |t|^{-2} \sum_{\nu \in k^\times} \Phi_f(t^{-2}\nu)$ and $\delta_B(a)^{-1} C = \hat{\Phi}_f(0)$ after the $\tilde{k}$-integration,

$$J^T_{\mathrm{unip}}(f) = \mathrm{vol}\big(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})}\big) f(1) + \int_{|t| \le e^T} G(t)\, d^\times t + \int_{|t| > e^T} \big(G(t) - \hat{\Phi}_f(0)\big)\, d^\times t.$$

Now $Z(f,s) = \int G(t)|t|^{2-2s} d^\times t$. Split it at $|t| = e^T$ and write $G = (G - \hat{\Phi}_f(0)) + \hat{\Phi}_f(0)$ on $|t| > e^T$. Since $\int_{|t|>e^T} |t|^{2-2s} d^\times t = c_k\, e^{(2-2s)T}/(2s-2)$,

$$Z(f,s) = \int_{|t| \le e^T} G|t|^{2-2s} + \int_{|t|>e^T} \big(G - \hat{\Phi}_f(0)\big)|t|^{2-2s} + c_k \hat{\Phi}_f(0) \frac{e^{(2-2s)T}}{2s-2}.$$

The first integral is entire in s (compact range of $|t|$). By the Poisson formula above, $G - \hat{\Phi}_f(0) = \sum_{\nu \ne 0} \hat{\Phi}_f(t^2\nu) - |t|^{-2}\Phi_f(0)$, so the second integral is an entire function minus $c_k \Phi_f(0) e^{-2sT}/(2s)$. This gives the continuation and the poles. Expanding $e^{(2-2s)T}/(2s-2) = 1/(2(s-1)) - T + O(s-1)$ gives (4.10). The second form of (4.9) follows by writing $k^\times$ as the union of the cosets $\xi k^{\times 2}$ and unfolding $\sum_{c \in k^\times/\{\pm 1\}}$ against $k^\times\backslash\mathbb{A}_k^\times$, using $|ct| = |t|$. □

The linear term of (4.10) agrees with the fine expansion: the term $\frac{1}{2} a^A(S,1) J^T_A(1,f)$ there has weight $v_A + 2T$, and $a^A(S,1) = c_k$, J_G of the class induced from 1 tends to $\hat{\Phi}_f(0)$ (Lemma 4.10). The 1995 formula (4.5) keeps only the $f(\mu)$-term of a central class (item II.6). In `book7d.tex`, J_{unip} is defined by truncating at $T_0 = 0$, which is correct here only because the integral converges at $T = 0$; in general it must be the polynomial evaluated at 0 (item A.5).

Example 4.A. Let $k = \mathbb{Q}$ and $\Phi = \Phi_\infty \otimes \mathbf{1}_{\hat{\mathbb{Z}}}$ with $\Phi_\infty(y) = e^{-\pi y^2}$, so $\hat{\Phi}(0) = 1$, and take $d^\times t$ with $\mathrm{vol}(\hat{\mathbb{Z}}^\times) = 1$, so $c_\mathbb{Q} = 1$. Representing $\mathbb{Q}^\times\backslash\mathbb{A}^\times$ by $\mathbb{R}_{>0} \times \hat{\mathbb{Z}}^\times$, $Z(s) = \int_0^\infty u^{-2s} \sum_{\nu\neq 0} e^{-\pi\nu^2/u^4}\, du/u = \zeta(s)M(s)$ with $M(s) = \int_0^\infty e^{-\pi w^2} w^{s-1} dw = \frac{1}{2}\pi^{-s/2}\Gamma(s/2)$. The residue at $s = 1$ is $M(1) = \frac{1}{2} = c_\mathbb{Q}\hat{\Phi}(0)/2$, and

$$\operatorname*{FP}_{s=1} Z(s) = \gamma_E M(1) + M'(1) = \frac{\gamma_E}{4} - \frac{\log 4\pi}{4} \approx -0.48845.$$

In the second form of (4.9), ξ runs over $\pm m$ with m squarefree, each contributing $m^{-s}M(s)\zeta(2s)$, and $\sum_m m^{-s} = \zeta(s)/\zeta(2s)$. The check script computes the truncated integrals of the proof of Proposition 4.8 at $T = -0.3, 0, 0.5, 1.2$ and finds that $J^T_{\mathrm{unip}} - \mathrm{vol}\cdot f(1) - T$ equals this constant to 14 digits.

Proof of Theorem 4.5. (a) $k^T(x) = \sum_\mathcal{O} k^T_\mathcal{O}(x)$ by Lemma 4.2. If $k^T_\mathcal{O} \not\equiv 0$, then some element of $\mathcal{O}$, or some μn with $\mu \in \mathcal{O} \cap A(\mathbb{Q})$, is $G(\mathbb{A})$-conjugate into the support of f; its trace lies in k and in a compact subset of $\mathbb{A}_k$, so in a finite set. This leaves the two central classes, finitely many hyperbolic classes, and the elliptic classes with finitely many characteristic polynomials. The $SL(2,k)$-classes with a given regular elliptic characteristic polynomial, splitting field E, form a torsor under $k^\times/N_{E/k}E^\times$, which injects into $\bigoplus_v k_v^\times/NE_v^\times$ by the Hasse norm theorem [CF]. Let v be a finite place outside a finite set, where $f_v = e_v$, E_v/k_v is unramified and μ is a unit with $|D(\mu)|_v = 1$. If v splits in E, the local class is unique. If v is inert, an element $\gamma \in K_v$ with the characteristic polynomial of μ has irreducible reduction, so it fixes no edge of the Bruhat–Tits tree and exactly one vertex, that of K_v. If $\gamma' = m\gamma m^{-1} \in K_v$ with $m \in GL(2,k_v)$, then m fixes that vertex, so $m \in k_v^\times GL(2,\mathcal{O}_v)$ and $\det m \in k_v^{\times 2}\mathcal{O}_v^\times = NE_v^\times$; correcting m by an element of the centralizer $E_v^\times$ makes it lie in $SL(2,k_v)$. So one local class meets K_v. Hence only finitely many local classes, and so finitely many global classes, meet the support of f.

(b) and (d) are Propositions 4.6, 4.7 and 4.8. (c) follows from (a) and (b). □

4.4 Local distributions

Test functions. Let S be a finite set of places of $\mathbb{Q}$ containing ∞ and 2, and let S_k be the set of places of k above S. Let $\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)}$ be the cover of $G(\mathbb{Q}_S) = \prod_{v\in S_k} SL(2,k_v)$ defined by $\prod_{v\in S_k}\sigma_v$, the quotient of $\prod_{v\in S_k}\overline{SL(2,k_v)}$ as in Section 2.1. Let $\mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)})$ be the span of the products $\bigotimes_{v\in S_k} f_v$, $f_v \in C_c^\infty(\overline{SL(2,k_v)})_-$, with f_v bi-$\overline{K_v}$-finite at archimedean v (so f_∞ is in C_c^∞, not C^∞ as in `book7d.tex`). As there, let $\mathcal{H}_N(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)})_\Gamma$, for $N > 0$ and a finite set Γ of irreducible representations of $\overline{K_S}$, be the subspace of functions supported on $\{\|g\| \le e^N\}$ whose left and right $\overline{K_S}$-translates span representations with constituents in Γ. With the seminorms $\sup|Df|$, D a differential operator on $\overline{G(\mathbb{R})}$, it is a Fréchet space, and $\mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)})$ is the union over N and Γ. For $f_S \in \mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)})$ put $f = f_S \otimes e^S$, $e^S = \bigotimes_{v\notin S_k} e_v$. For $\gamma \in G(\mathbb{Q})$ let $\gamma_S = (\gamma, \kappa_\mathbb{A}(\gamma)) \in \overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)}$; since $e_v((k,\zeta)_\sigma) = \zeta$ for $k \in K_v$, $f(\gamma) = f_S(\gamma_S)$ when $\gamma \in K_v$ for all $v \notin S_k$.

`book7d.tex` asserts that Arthur's spaces of almost compactly supported and moderate functions [A9] coincide with $\mathcal{H}$ for both G and A. For G this holds, because $A_G = 1$. For A it fails: $\mathfrak{a}_A = \mathfrak{a} \neq 0$, and a function that is compactly supported on each fiber of H need not be compactly supported.

Orbital integrals. At each $v \in S_k$ we use the local measures of Section 2.1.5, and on $G(\mathbb{Q}_S)$ their product. For $\gamma = a(t) \in A(\mathbb{Q}_S)$ with $t_v^2 \neq 1$ for all v, and γ also denoting a lift in $\overline{A(\mathbb{Q}_S)}$, let $D(\gamma) = \prod_v (t_v - t_v^{-1})^2$, and

$$J_G(\gamma, f_S) = |D(\gamma)|^{1/2} \int_{A(\mathbb{Q}_S)\backslash G(\mathbb{Q}_S)} f_S(x^{-1}\gamma x)\, dx, \tag{4.11}$$

$$J_A(\gamma, f_S) = |D(\gamma)|^{1/2} \int_{A(\mathbb{Q}_S)\backslash G(\mathbb{Q}_S)} f_S(x^{-1}\gamma x)\, v_A(x)\, dx, \qquad v_A(x) = \sum_{v \in S_k} v_{A,v}(x_v), \tag{4.12}$$

where $v_{A,v}(x) = -H_v(x) - H_v(wx)$ is the local weight. For $\gamma = \mu_S$ regular elliptic, $J_G(\gamma, f_S)$ is defined by (4.11) with the centralizer $T_\mu(\mathbb{Q}_S)$ in place of $A(\mathbb{Q}_S)$. For a unipotent $u \in G(\mathbb{Q}_S)$ and $z \in \{\pm 1\}$, $J_G(zu, f_S) = \int_{G_u(\mathbb{Q}_S)\backslash G(\mathbb{Q}_S)} f_S(x^{-1}zux)\, dx$. These integrals converge absolutely, and the quotient measures are those of (2.9): on $A(\mathbb{Q}_S)\backslash G(\mathbb{Q}_S)$, $dx = dn\, dk$ for $x = nk$.

Lemma 4.9. *Let v be a place of k. Then $v_{A,v} \geq 0$, it is left $A(k_v)$-invariant and right K_v-invariant, and*

$$v_{A,v}(n(y)k) = \log \|(1,y)\|_v = \begin{cases} \log \max(1, |y|_v), & v \text{ finite}, \\ \tfrac{1}{2}\log(1+y^2), & v \text{ real}, \\ \log(1+|y|^2), & v \text{ complex}. \end{cases}$$

For $x \in G(\mathbb{A})$, $v_A(x) = \sum_v v_{A,v}(x_v)$, a finite sum.

Proof. As for Lemma 4.3, at one place: $|\det(e_2 x; e_2 wx)|_v = |-1|_v = 1$ gives $v_{A,v} \geq 0$, and $H_v(n(y)) = 0$, $e_2 wn(y) = (1, y)$. The global identity is $H = \sum_v H_v$. □

At a p-adic place the weight is $\log \max(1, |y|_p)$, not $\log \sqrt{|1+y^2|_p}$ as in `book7d.tex` and (7.13) of the 1995 notes (items II.22, A.6); the latter is the real formula.

Lemma 4.10. *Let $f_S = \bigotimes_{v \in S_k} f_v$, $z \in \{\pm 1\}$, and let $\Phi_v(y) = \int_{K_v} f_v(\tilde{k}^{-1} z(n(y), 1)\tilde{k})\, d\tilde{k}$, a Schwartz–Bruhat function on k_v, with $\hat{\Phi}_v(0) = \int_{k_v} \Phi_v$. For $t \in k_S^\times$ near 1 let $a_t = (a(t), 1)z$ and*

$$r(t) = \sum_{v \in S_k} \log \bigl| t_v^2 - t_v^{-2} \bigr|_v .$$

(a) $J_G(a_t, f_S) \to \prod_v \hat{\Phi}_v(0)$ as $t \to 1$.

(b) The limit

$$J_A(z, f_S) := \lim_{t \to 1} \bigl(J_A(a_t, f_S) + r(t)\, J_G(a_t, f_S) \bigr) = \sum_{v \in S_k} \Bigl(\int_{k_v} \Phi_v(y) \log |2y|_v \, dy \Bigr) \prod_{w \in S_k \smallsetminus \{v\}} \hat{\Phi}_w(0)$$

exists. Without the term $r(t) J_G$, $J_A(a_t, f_S) = -\log|1 - t^{-2}|_S \prod_v \hat{\Phi}_v(0) + O(1)$, which diverges unless $\prod_v \hat{\Phi}_v(0) = 0$.

(c) For $\xi \in k_S^\times$, $J_G(z\, n(\xi), f_S) = \prod_{v \in S_k} \frac{1}{2} \int_{k_v^\times} \Phi_v(\xi t^2) |t|_v^2 \, d^\times t$.

Proof. Everything factors over $v \in S_k$, J_A by the Leibniz rule $J_A = \sum_v J_{A,v} \prod_{w \neq v} J_{G,w}$, and $r(t) = \sum_v r_v(t_v)$; so it suffices to treat one place. For $x = n(y)k$, $x^{-1}a_t x = \tilde{k}^{-1}a_t(n(\varepsilon y),1)\tilde{k}$ with $\varepsilon = 1 - t^{-2}$, and $|D(a(t))|^{1/2} = |t|\,|\varepsilon|$. Put $y' = \varepsilon y$ and $h_t(y') = \int f_v(\tilde{k}^{-1}a_t(n(y'),1)\tilde{k})\,d\tilde{k}$. By Lemma 4.9 and homogeneity of $\|\cdot\|_v$,

$$J_{G,v} = |t| \int h_t(y')\,dy', \qquad J_{A,v} = |t| \int h_t(y')\big(\log\|(\varepsilon,y')\|_v - \log|\varepsilon|_v\big)\,dy'.$$

This gives (a), since $h_t \to \Phi_v$ with uniformly compact support, and the asymptotics in (b). Since $t^2 - t^{-2} = t^2\varepsilon(1+t^{-2})$,

$$J_{A,v} + r_v J_{G,v} = |t| \int h_t(y')\big(\log\|(\varepsilon,y')\|_v + \log|t^2(1+t^{-2})|_v\big)\,dy' \to \int \Phi_v(y)\big(\log|y|_v + \log|2|_v\big)\,dy$$

by dominated convergence ($\log|y|_v$ is locally integrable). For (c), $G_{n(\xi)} = \{\pm 1\}N$, so the integral is over $\{\pm1\}\backslash A(k_v) \times K_v$ with measure $\frac{1}{2}\delta_B(a)^{-1}da\,dk$, and $a(t)^{-1}n(\xi)a(t) = n(t^{-2}\xi)$; substitute $t \mapsto t^{-1}$. □

Lemma 4.10(b) is Arthur's definition [A7, (8.1)] of $J_M(\gamma, f)$ at a non-regular point, as the limit of $\sum_{L \in \mathcal{L}(M)} r_M^L(\gamma,a) J_L(a\gamma, f)$, specialized to $M = A$, $\gamma = z$: $r_A^A = 1$, and $r_A^G(1,a)$ is the function $r(t)$ above (Remark 2026.8). The Example in `book7d.tex` sets $r_A = 1$ and takes the plain limit of $J_A(az, f)$, which diverges (item A.2): the class induced from $1 \in A$ to G is the regular unipotent class, so the term $L = G$ is present.

4.5 The fine expansion

For S as above let $\mathcal{U}_S$ be the set of (G,S)-equivalence classes of unipotent elements of $G(\mathbb{Q})$, that is, the classes $\{1\}$ and $u_\xi = n(\xi)$, $\xi \in k_S^\times / k_S^{\times 2}$ (each meets $G(\mathbb{Q})$, by weak approximation). For $v \notin S_k$ we use Haar measures giving K_v, $A(\mathcal{O}_v)$ and $T_\mu(\mathcal{O}_v)$ volume 1, and global measures that are products of these with the measures at S_k; the volumes below are taken with respect to them.

Theorem 4.11 (Arthur [A12, Thm. 8.1]; Li [Li I] for covers)**.** *Let $f_S \in \mathcal{H}(\overline{G(\mathbb{Q}_S)})$ and $f = f_S \otimes e^S$. If S is large enough (depending on the support of f_S), then:*

(a) for $z \in \{\pm 1\}$,

$$J_{\mathcal{O}_z}(f) = a^G(S,1) f_S(z) + \sum_{\xi \in k_S^\times / k_S^{\times 2}} a^G(S,u_\xi)\, J_G(z\,u_\xi, f_S) + \tfrac{1}{2}\, a^A(S,1)\, J_A(z, f_S),$$

with $a^G(S,1) = \mathrm{vol}(G(\mathbb{Q})\backslash\overline{G(\mathbb{A})})$, $a^A(S,1) = c_k$, and $J_A(z,f_S)$ as in Lemma 4.10(b);

(b) for $\mathcal{O}$ elliptic with $\mu \in \mathcal{O}$, $J_\mathcal{O}(f) = a^G(S,\mu) J_G(\mu_S, f_S)$ with $a^G(S,\mu) = \mathrm{vol}(T_\mu(\mathbb{Q})\backslash T_\mu(\mathbb{A}))$;

(c) for $\mathcal{O}$ hyperbolic with $\mu = a(t) \in \mathcal{O}$, $J_\mathcal{O}(f) = a^A(S,\mu) J_A(\mu_S, f_S)$ with $a^A(S,\mu) = c_k$.

In Arthur's notation the right-hand sides are $\sum_{M \in \{A,G\}} |W_0^M||W_0^G|^{-1} \sum_\gamma a^M(S,\gamma) J_M(\gamma, f_S)$, with γ running over the (M,S)-classes in $M(\mathbb{Q}) \cap \mathcal{O}$; in (c) the factor $\frac{1}{2}$ cancels against the two elements $\mu^{\pm 1}$, since $J_A(\mu^{-1}, f_S) = J_A(\mu, f_S)$. (Substitute $x = wy$, and use $v_A(wy) = -H(wy) - H(-y) = v_A(y)$.) Parts (b) and (c) follow from Propositions 4.7 and 4.6:

for S large, $|D(\mu)|_S = |D(\mu)|_{\mathbb{A}_k} = 1$, and at $v \notin S_k$ the orbital integrals of e_v equal 1 while $v_{A,v} = 0$ on their support. For the same reason $f(\gamma) = f_S(\gamma_S)$, which is why the lift μ_S carries the global factor $\kappa_{\mathbb{A}}(\mu)$. In (a) the coefficient of $f_S(z)$ and the linear term agree with Proposition 4.8. The coefficients $a^G(S, u_\xi)$ are defined by (a); they are not computed here (Remark 2026.9).

This is the corrected form of the Proposition of `book7d.tex` (cited in the 1995 Section 6 as "Proposition 4.18"), which credits the result for covers to [A12, Thm. 8.1]; Arthur proves it for connected reductive groups, and for covers it is Li's theorem [Li I] (item A.1). The coefficients are defined with centralizers in the cover, which for $n = 2$ are the full preimages (Lemma 4.1). The sums run over (G, S)-classes, not over the rational class $\mathcal{O}$ (item A.7). Sections 5.4(a) and 6.4(a) must use (a) in full; in the 1995 text, 5.4(a) has only $a^G(S, z)f(z) + \frac{1}{2}a^A(S, z)J_A(z, f)$.

Remark 2026.8. *Normalizations on* $\mathfrak{a}$. Identify $\mathfrak{a}$ with $\mathbb{R}$ by $X \mapsto X(\chi_1)$, $\chi_1 = N_{k/\mathbb{Q}} \circ t$, as in Section 2.1.3. The coroot is $\alpha^\vee \colon s \mapsto a(s)$, $s \in \mathbb{Q}^\times$, so $\alpha^\vee = \langle \chi_1, \alpha^\vee \rangle = d$, and the simple root α of (B, A_B), $a(s) \mapsto s^2$, is $\alpha = (2/d)\chi_1$, i.e. $\alpha(X) = 2X/d$. (Section 2 has been corrected accordingly; it previously had $\alpha(X) = 2X$, which holds only for $k = \mathbb{Q}$.) The modulus is $\delta_B = e^{2H}$ for every k. We use Lebesgue measure dX on $\mathfrak{a}$, for which $\mathfrak{a}/\mathbb{Z}\alpha^\vee$ has volume d; Arthur normalizes it to volume 1. With Arthur's normalization, $\theta_B(\lambda) = \lambda(\alpha^\vee)$, the weight v_A and the function r_A^G are divided by d, and $\mathrm{vol}(A(\mathbb{Q})\backslash A(\mathbb{A})^1)$ is multiplied by d; the products in (4.7) and Theorem 4.11 do not change. With $\theta_P(\lambda)$ in our normalization, Arthur's $r_A^G(1, a) = \lim_{\lambda \to 0} \sum_{P \in \mathcal{P}(A)} r_P(\lambda, 1, a)\theta_P(\lambda)^{-1}$ [A7, §3] with $r_P(\lambda, 1, a) = |a^\beta - a^{-\beta}|^{\lambda(\beta^\vee)/2}$ evaluates to $r(t)$ for $a = a(t)$, $t \in \mathbb{Q}_S^\times$. We have checked this only for the formula of [A7] as quoted in `book7d.tex`, not against the general definition of the exponents $\rho(\beta, u)$ there. The independent check is that the limit in Lemma 4.10(b) exists.

Remark 2026.9. *What rests on citation.* Theorem 4.5 and Propositions 4.6–4.8 are proved here. Theorem 4.11(a) is taken from [A12, Li I]: the coefficients $a^G(S, u_\xi)$ are defined by it, and we have not derived (a) from Proposition 4.8. Doing so amounts to computing $a^G(S, u_\xi)$ from the Laurent expansion at $s = 1$ of the second form of (4.9), grouped by the image of ξ in $k_S^\times / k_S^{\times 2}$. Each fiber is infinite, and its contribution is a Dirichlet series in s, so a regularization is needed. This is the divergence of (7.17) in the 1995 notes (item II.21), and is left to stage 6. The unramified computations used for (b)–(c) of Theorem 4.11 are standard and not written out. For an elliptic μ they use the uniqueness of the local class meeting K_v from the proof of Theorem 4.5(a).

Remark 2026.10. The script `checks/sec4_n2_check.py` verifies, for $k = \mathbb{Q}$: that the Iwasawa height computed from an explicit decomposition equals $-\log \|e_2 g\|_v$ at $v = \infty, 2, 3, 5, 7$; the inequality $H(x) + H(\gamma x) \le 0$ on random adelic x and $\gamma \in SL(2, \mathbb{Q}) \smallsetminus B(\mathbb{Q})$, and $H(\gamma x) = H(x)$ for $\gamma \in B(\mathbb{Q})$; Lemma 4.3(c) and Lemma 4.9; the weight integral in the proof of Proposition 4.6; the conjugation identities used there (symbolically); Lemma 4.10(b) at $v = \mathbb{R}$ (quadrature) and $v = \mathbb{Q}_3$ (exactly), including the divergence without $r(t)$; the symmetry $J_A(\mu^{-1}) = J_A(\mu)$ at $\mathbb{R}$; and Example 4.A.

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